

CITY: PG 3

CM inspects North Delhi, flags open drains, cleanliness lapses



NATION: PG 5

Rahul alleges PM Modi went to Israel complying with Trump's diktat



FILM: PG 16

'There's no fun in playing vanilla characters'



US-IRAN TALKS EXPECTED IN ISLAMABAD, BUT SCHEDULE REMAINS UNCONFIRMED

Uncertainty prevails over 2nd round of talks

PTI & ASSOCIATED PRESS

ISLAMABAD: Uncertainty prevailed over the much-touted second round of peace talks between the US and Iran on Monday, amid exhibitory brinkmanship by both sides.

The two sides are expected to meet in the coming days in Islamabad, for which Pakistani authorities have taken elaborate security measures. A two-week ceasefire between the US and Iran is set to expire on Wednesday.

The next phase of peace talks between the US and Iran appear to be uncertain ahead of Wednesday's ceasefire deadline. A US delegation headed by Vice-President JD Vance will travel to Pakistan "soon" but no timings are confirmed. But Iran said it has "no plans for the next round" of negotiations in Islamabad. One sticking point for Iran is said to be the US naval blockade of the Strait of Hormuz, which escalated when the US attacked and seized an Iranian cargo ship on Sunday.

On Monday, Iran's Foreign Ministry Spokesperson Esmail Baqaei said that his country has yet to decide whether to attend the next round of talks with the US.

Earlier, Iranian Parliament



Police officers stand guard at a checkpoint to ensure security ahead of the second round of negotiations between the U.S. and Iran, in Islamabad, Pakistan, on Monday

Speaker Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf said Tehran was continuing negotiations with the US but remained ready to take "necessary measures", amid fears of renewed escalation.

On the other side, US President Donald Trump said the US Navy targeted an Iranian ship trying to evade the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz.

Addressing a weekly press briefing in Tehran on Monday,

Baqaei said, "As of now, while I am at your service, we have no plans for the next round of negotiation, and no decision has been made in this regard."

The foreign ministry spokesman elaborated that the US was not serious about pursuing diplomacy, citing "violations" of their two-week ceasefire.

He highlighted that the US attack on the Iranian cargo

ship early on Monday, the US naval blockade of Iranian ports, and delays in implementing a ceasefire in Lebanon were all "clear violations of the ceasefire."

"Regarding the issue of transferring enriched uranium, neither during this period of negotiations nor before has transferring it to the United States been discussed," Baqaei said.

CLOSER LOOK

» Two-week US-Iran ceasefire set to expire Wednesday

» US delegation led by JD Vance to travel "soon", timing unclear

» Iran says it has "no plans" for next negotiation round

» Key dispute: US naval blockade of Strait of Hormuz

» US seizes Iranian cargo ship, intensifying tensions

» Iran undecided on attending Islamabad talks, says spokesperson Baqaei

» Tehran accuses US of ceasefire violations and lack of seriousness

» Iran denies discussing transfer of enriched uranium to US

India in touch with Iranian authorities for safe exit of its ships, says MEA

NEW DELHI: India is in touch with the Iranian authorities for the safety of its ships and for their safe exit through the Strait of Hormuz, the Ministry of External Affairs said on Monday.

The comments by MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal at an inter-ministerial briefing here on the West Asia situation came in response to a query on two Indian vessels having reported a firing incident recently while transiting the critical maritime sea lane. Details were also sought about the steps New Delhi has taken to ensure safety of Indian vessels.

"In the past 48 hours, two Indian vessels, VLCC Samnar Herald and Bulk Carrier Jag Arnab, reported a firing incident while transiting the Strait of Hormuz, following which they returned to the Persian Gulf. There has been no injury to any crew reported," the Indian government said in an official statement after the briefing.

The safety and security of Indian seafarers is the top priority of government of India, it said.

"We have several of our ships in the Persian Gulf. And we have been in touch with Iran and others,"



Will continue to keep tab on development work in Bihar

Nitish Kumar

In today's paper

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CITY

JNUSU SEEKS RELEASE OF STUDENTS 2

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INTERNATIONAL

UK CALLS FOR 'TOLL-FREE' HORMUZ 8

BUSINESS

RUPEE FALLS 25 PAISE TO 93.16 PER DOLLAR 10

SPORT

TILAK SCORES MAIDEN TON 16

India, South Korea push peace message, target to double trade to \$50 billion by 2030

Modi, Lee agree to upgrade trade pact within a year



Prime Minister Narendra Modi and South Korean President Lee Jae Myung during a bilateral meeting, in New Delhi

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India and South Korea on Monday set an ambitious target to nearly double their bilateral trade to \$50 billion by 2030, alongside a decision to upgrade their existing trade agreement within a year, as Prime Minister Narendra Modi and South Korean President Lee Jae Myung held wide-ranging talks in New Delhi against a backdrop of global tensions and shifting geopolitical dynamics. The leaders coupled economic goals with a broader strategic message, highlighting their shared commitment to stability and cooperation in an increasingly uncertain international environment. Prime Minister Modi noted that both nations radiate a

“IN THIS PERIOD OF GLOBAL TENSIONS, INDIA AND KOREA TOGETHER CONVEY A MESSAGE OF PEACE AND STABILITY”

message of peace and stability amid the current global tension.

Following delegation-level discussions, the two countries signed 15 agreements spanning sectors such as industrial cooperation and steel supply chains, signalling an effort to deepen economic integration and diversify critical supply networks. Both sides also outlined plans to expand collaboration in energy, defence, critical minerals, semiconductors, and shipbuilding, sectors seen as central to

Quick News

SC REJECTS UMAR'S BAIL REVIEW PLEA IN DELHI RIOTS CASE

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has rejected activist Umar Khalid's review plea against the January 5, 2026 order denying him bail in the 2020 Delhi riots case, stating there were "no good ground and reason" to revisit the verdict. A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and N V Anjaria, in an April 16 order, also refused an oral hearing. The court had earlier found prima facie evidence of Khalid and Sharjeel Imam's role in planning and mobilisation under UAPA. Both remain jailed since 2020. The February riots left 53 dead and over 700 injured. Eleven of 18 accused have secured bail so far.

See P2

FIRE AT RAJ REFINERY A DAY BEFORE INAUGURATION BY PM



NEW DELHI/JAIPUR: A fire erupted Monday near the crude distillation unit of the Rs 79,450 crore HPCL Rajasthan Refinery at Pachpadra, a day before its planned inauguration by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Officials said the blaze, which sent up thick black smoke, was contained within two hours with no casualties. The Petroleum Ministry said the April 21 event was postponed and a probe launched. HPCL cited a possible hydrocarbon leak.

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A fresh spell of extreme weather is set to sweep large parts of India this week, with the India Meteorological Department warning of heatwave conditions across northwest, central and adjoining eastern regions even as heavy rain triggered flooding and a fatality in Assam.

According to the IMD, heatwave conditions are very likely to affect isolated pockets of Haryana, Chandigarh, Delhi, Punjab, East and West Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Vidarbha, Chhattisgarh, West Uttar Pradesh, Gangetic West Bengal, Jharkhand and Odisha, along with some parts of East Uttar Pradesh, between April 20 and April 25. The weather office



A boy pours a bucket of water to beat the heat on a hot summer day, in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh

said the conditions could persist for the next four to five days, raising concerns over rising temperatures and public health risks.

The department also forecast hot and humid conditions in sev-

eral coastal and eastern regions, including Gangetic West Bengal between April 20 and 26, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal from April 20 to 22, and Kerala, Mahe, Coastal Andhra Pradesh

and Yanam through April 24. Coastal Gujarat is expected to experience similar conditions on April 24 and 25. Warm night conditions are likely in parts of Haryana, Chandigarh, West Uttar

COOLING DOWN

A caretaker showers Rajlakshmi, an Asian elephant, to beat the heat at the National Zoological Park, in New Delhi, on Monday

PTI

51 PEOPLE INJURED

Bus rolls down hill in J&K; 21 dead

MPOST BUREAU

JAMMU: A major road accident claimed 21 lives and left 51 people injured on Monday morning after a packed passenger bus reeled off a hill and fell nearly 100 metres down a slope in Udhampur district of Jammu and Kashmir, crushing an auto-rickshaw beneath it before landing upside down on the road below.

The bus, which was carrying more than 65 passengers, including women and students, was travelling its routine route from Ramnagar to Udhampur when the driver lost control while navigating a blind curve near Kagort village in the Ramnagar area at



Wrecked remains of a passenger bus after it rolled down a hill, in Jammu and Kashmir's Udhampur district, on Monday

around 10 am. Most of those on board were daily commuters who make this journey regularly, many of them familiar faces to one another, bound for work and school.

The impact was devastating. The bus was reduced to what officials described as a mangled heap of iron, its top portion almost entirely torn away.

STATES ROLL OUT MEASURES TO TACKLE HEATWAVE CONDITIONS

'Heatwave to grip large parts of India for next 5 days'

MPOST BUREAU

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CLOSER LOOK

» Heatwave likely in Delhi, UP, Rajasthan, MP, Jharkhand, Odisha, and adjoining regions

» Conditions expected between April 20 and April 25 in multiple states

» Hot and humid weather forecast in eastern and southern coastal regions

» Warm night conditions expected in parts of north and central India

» Thunderstorms likely across south, central, east, and northwest India on Monday

» Hailstorms possible in parts of Maharashtra, MP, Vidarbha, and Chhattisgarh

Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Vidarbha early in the week, with Odisha and Chhattisgarh also expected to see uncomfortable night temperatures.

Alongside the heat, the IMD said moderate to intense thunderstorms could develop across parts of south, central, east and northwest India on Monday. There is also a possibility of hailstorms in isolated pockets of Madhya Maharashtra, Marathwada, Madhya Pradesh, Vidarbha and Chhattisgarh.

In response to the forecast, state governments have begun rolling out mitigation measures. In Uttar Pradesh, Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said coordinated action is underway to manage the

Delhi HC judge rules Kejriwal's 'illusions' no ground for her recusal

Says justice is not about giving in to pressure

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Delhi High Court judge Justice Swarna Kanta Sharma on Monday rejected a petition filed by Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) chief Arvind Kejriwal seeking her recusal from hearing matters linked to the Delhi liquor policy case.

"I reject this application because my oath is to the Constitution. My oath taught me that justice is not about giving in to pressure but about not surrendering to it. It is and will remain my resolve," Justice Sharma said, adding judicial integrity cannot be put to trial by litigants.

Justice Sharma said while the easier path would have been to recuse without hearing the application, she chose to decide the issue on the merits in the interest of institutional integrity.

"While I began penning the judgment, the courtroom fell silent," she said, adding the issue before her was not a legal question but one that put a judge and the institution itself "on trial."

Justice Sharma said the impartiality of a judge is presumed unless rebutted by cogent material, and that recusal cannot be granted on the basis of "mere apprehension or personal perception" of a litigant.

"A litigant cannot be permitted to create a situation that lowers the judicial process. A lie, even if repeated a thousand times in court or on social media, does not become the truth," she said.

"If I recused myself, Kejriwal would say, 'Look I was right.' If I don't recuse and he fails to get any relief from me in future, he will say he knew the outcome already. If I recused myself today, I would be abandoning my duty. Arvind Kejriwal has said so many times while arguing that he is not doubting my integrity

TAKEAWAYS

- » Justice Sharma says oath to Constitution requires resisting pressure, not surrendering to it
- » Court rules judicial integrity cannot be put on trial by litigants
- » Says issue put judiciary itself "on trial," not merely a legal question
- » Reaffirms presumption of judicial impartiality unless proven with cogent evidence
- » Rules recusal cannot rest on litigant's apprehensions or personal perceptions

but he has doubts in his mind. Such illusions in the mind of Kejriwal cannot be ground for recusal," Justice Sharma said.

Justice Sharma also strongly objected to the allegation of her having a conflict of interest in hearing the case as her children are on the central government's panel and receive cases through the solicitor general who represented the CBI, saying there is a clear distinction between a conflict of interest and an "attempt" to create an impression of conflict of interest.

She said none of her children has any "proximity" or "nexus" to the excise-policy case and if the plea of Kejriwal and others is accepted, the children of judges can never enter the legal profession, which would also take away their fundamental rights.

In the pronouncement that lasted for more than an hour, Justice Sharma said a litigant cannot be allowed to judge a judge without any material, and judges cannot recuse themselves to satisfy a litigant's unfounded apprehension of bias.

She added that a political leader cannot be allowed to damage an

JEE-Main results: 26 candidates bag perfect 100 NTA score

NEW DELHI: Twenty-six candidates have bagged a perfect 100 NTA score in the engineering entrance exam JEE-Main, the National Testing Agency (NTA) announced on Monday.

Twenty-four candidates had achieved the feat in 2025.

While over 13 lakh candidates had appeared in the first edition of the crucial exam in January, more than 10 lakh candidates had appeared in the second edition in April. Over eight lakh common candidates appeared in both sessions.

Among the candidates who have secured an NTA score of 100, five each are from Andhra Pradesh and Telangana followed by four from Rajasthan, three from Delhi and two each from Maharashtra and Haryana.

One candidate each from Chandigarh, Bihar, Tamil Nadu, Odisha and Gujarat have achieved the feat. All 26 candidates are male.

According to officials, the NTA score is not the same as the percentage of marks obtained but normalised scores.

"The NTA scores are normalised scores across multi-shift papers and are based on the relative performance

PREET VIHAR

Weeks before child’s birth, man loses his life after parking dispute escalates

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A home that was eagerly counting down the days to welcome a new baby this July has been shattered by an unexpected tragedy. Pankaj Nayyar, who was preparing to become a father for the second time, was shot dead in East Delhi’s Preet Vihar during the early hours of Monday.

The incident occurred following a seemingly minor parking dispute that escalated into fatal violence, leaving behind his seven-months-pregnant wife and a grieving family. On Sunday night, Nayyar (34) had visited his elder brother Paras (43) at their family home in Preet Vihar. The very evening, a fight broke out between Paras and his neighbour, Gaurav Sharma, who had moved into the first floor about four months earlier.

“He owned three cars,



including a BMW and a Toyota Fortuner, despite having parking space for only one,” Nayyar’s cousin, Anup Nasa (50), said.

He added that their parents were out of town attending a neighbour’s wedding in Jim Corbett on the day of the incident. “On the day of the incident, Paras was alone in the house. He got anxious and called his brother over from Noida,” Nasa said.

Nayyar worked as a garment trader in Chandni Chowk

and lived in Noida’s Sector 121 with his wife and five-year-old son. The trouble began when Sharma parked his Toyota Fortuner in front of the main gate of the house, despite already occupying the designated parking space with his BMW.

“They requested him to park properly, even suggesting using another building’s space, but he didn’t listen,” Nasa added, noting that the family owned the first floor of the neighbouring building.

While the dispute seemed

“The incident occurred following a seemingly minor parking dispute that escalated into fatal violence”

resolved after Sharma finally moved his BMW to the nearby building’s parking lot, it didn’t last. Just minutes later, Paras called Nayyar, saying Sharma had returned and was again hurling insults and causing a scene outside the house.

According to Nasa, “Nayyar had already left. When his brother called him, Pankaj even called Sharma, asking why he was fighting after everything had been sorted.” When Paras called again, Pankaj returned to help.

The family alleged the murder was a planned attack. Nasa

stated, “They were already waiting downstairs,” referring to the group consisting of Sharma, his son, his nephew, and two others. They attacked Nayyar the moment he arrived, he claimed.

According to the police, three rounds were fired, one of which hit Nayyar in the chest, killing him on the spot. “They killed my cousin and fled in another car,” Nasa alleged.

Another family member claimed that they even attempted to kill Paras, who was assaulted during the attack and was struck with a gun.

Pankaj Nayyar married six years ago after an eight-year relationship, overcoming religious differences.

Family members described him as warm and dependable. He was killed following a parking dispute; police have registered an FIR and arrested the accused.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

SC rejects Khalid’s bail review plea

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court has dismissed activist Umar Khalid’s plea seeking a review of a verdict denying him bail, while observing that there are reasonable grounds to believe the allegations levelled against him in connection with a conspiracy behind the 2020 Delhi riots.

A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and N V Anjaria also rejected a plea seeking an oral hearing of the review petition.

“Having gone through the review petition and also the documents enclosed, we do not find any good ground and reason to review the judgment dated January 5, 2026. Accordingly, the review petition is dismissed,” the bench said in its April 16 order.

According to the Supreme Court’s rules, review petitions are considered by judges who delivered a judgment or passed an order in chambers to remedy an apparent error or a resultant grave injustice that was a consequence of an apex court decision. Parties seeking a review can request judges for an open-court hearing to rectify the grave injus-



tice caused due to the decision under review.

Besides Khalid, the top court had, on January 5, refused bail to Sharjeel Imam but granted it to five others, saying all the accused did not stand on the same footing.

Khalid and Imam, who have been incarcerated since 2020, can file fresh bail pleas after the examination of the protected witnesses or after a year from the day the order was passed, the court had said, as it rejected their contention of a delay in the trial.

There was a prima-facie case against Khalid and Imam under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), the top court had said, noting that prosecution material suggests that they were involved in the “planning, mobilisation and strategic direction” of the riots.

While the two will remain in jail, activists Gulfisha Fatima, Meeran Haider, Shifa Ur Rehman, Mohammad Saleem Khan and Shadab Ahmad were given bail by the court, which had imposed 11 conditions and said any misuse of liberty would lead to cancellation of bail.

The court had noted that the guarantee of liberty enshrined under Article 21 of the Constitution is of foundational importance, but at the same time, the security of a community, the integrity of a trial process and the preservation of public order are equally legitimate constitutional concerns.

Khalid and Imam stood on qualitatively-different footing as compared to the other accused, the court had said.

The prosecution had prima facie disclosed “a central and formative role” and “involvement in the level of planning, mobilisation and strategic direction extending beyond episodic and localised acts”, the bench had said. The February 2020 riots in northeast Delhi broke out during protests against the CAA and the NRC, leaving 53 people dead and more than 700 injured.

Domestic help among 3 nabbed in Delhi Golf Links dacoity case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Three men have been arrested in connection with holding hostage and robbing the family of a businessman in Delhi’s upscale Golf Links area. Among the accused is the family’s domestic help, who had been hired days before the incident, police said on Monday.

The accused were identified as Guddu Kumar Kamat alias Raju (35), the domestic help, Raman Kamat alias Sushil (38), both residents of Bihar and Amit Singh alias Gabbar (30), a resident of Sangam Vihar in Delhi, they said.

Two of the accused, Guddu and Raman, were arrested from Mumbai, while Amit was apprehended from Uttar Pradesh on Sunday, Deputy Commissioner of Police (New

Delhi) Sachin Sharma said.

Police said the case pertains to a dacoity reported on April 17, where the domestic help had allegedly conspired with 5-6 accomplices to target his employer’s residence.

During the investigation, it was revealed that Raman, who had been employed at the house barely three days before the incident, deliberately opened the main gate to facilitate the entry of the gang members. The accused then entered the house, allegedly held family members hostage and fled with jewellery worth around Rs 25 lakh, the police said.

The route and movement of the suspects were traced through sustained technical surveillance and data analysis, which ultimately led to their identification and arrest, they said. “Guddu is a habit-

ual offender with prior involvement in seven cases of robbery and dacoity. He had earlier worked as a domestic servant at multiple locations and used that experience to identify vulnerable targets,” the officer said.

Raman was also found to be involved in similar criminal activities. Amit is a notorious auto-lifter (vehicle thief) with involvement in 19 criminal cases. He was roped in by the gang to provide logistical support for executing the crime, the police said.

“CCTV footage had shown multiple suspects approaching the residence and waiting for the right moment to enter, suggesting careful timing and coordination,” a police source had said. Efforts continue to trace the remaining accused and recover the looted property, the police said.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Two brothers carrying a total reward of Rs 50,000 on information leading to their arrest have been held from northwest Delhi in connection with the killing of a property dealer-cum-journalist in Uttar Pradesh’s Hathras, an official said on Monday.

Accused Kamal Sharma (38) and Gaurav Sharma (36) were apprehended from a spot near the Prembari drain in the Wazirpur Industrial Area following a tip-off about armed suspects moving in the locality.

Police said the duo were wanted in connection with the killing of Ved Prakash Sharma alias Sonu, a 35-year-old property dealer who was also associated with a local news platform in Hathras.

“He had gone missing on



April 6 and his body was found the next day from a drain near the Sadabad-Jalesar road,” a police officer said.

During investigation, it emerged that the killing was linked to a property dispute. The accused were allegedly pressuring the victim to sell his property, but he had refused, following which they hatched a plan to eliminate him.

A case was registered at the Sahpau police station in Hathras on April 7 and the accused were absconding since then.

‘After the incident, the UP Police had announced a reward of Rs 25,000 each on their arrest. Acting on specific intelligence received on April 17, a police team laid a trap and nabbed the two suspects’

“After the incident, the Uttar Pradesh Police had announced a reward of Rs 25,000 each on their arrest. Acting on specific intelligence received on April 17, a police team laid a trap and nabbed the two suspects,” the officer said.

During their search, officers seized a semi-automatic pistol with two live cartridges from Kamal Sharma and a country-made pistol along with a live cartridge from Gaurav Sharma.

A separate case was regis-

tered against both.

During interrogation, the accused confessed to their involvement in the killing in Hathras and said they were on the run to evade arrest, police said.

Further probe revealed that the duo are habitual offenders and have been previously involved in multiple criminal cases. Efforts are on to coordinate with the Uttar Pradesh Police for further legal proceedings in the murder case.

Speeding truck mows down couple and son

OUR CORRESPONDENT

FARIDABAD: Three members of a family were killed after a speeding truck hit them in the IMT area early Monday morning, police said.

The deceased, identified as Kashiram (44), a resident of Tikamgarh, Madhya Pradesh, his wife Angoori (39), and 16-year-old son, Vishal were walking towards the highway from an auto rickshaw stand when the incident happened, according to police.

The truck driver managed to flee the spot with his vehicle. An FIR has been registered, police said.

Vishal worked as a labourer in the IMT area, and the family lived in a rented house nearby.

Ghanshyam, brother-in-law of Kashiram, said that the three family members were

“The truck driver managed to flee the spot with his vehicle. An FIR has been registered”

leaving for their native village.

“I dropped them off at the auto stand. As they approached the highway, a truck coming from behind struck Kashiram, his wife and son. Kashiram died on the spot in the accident, while his wife and son were seriously injured. Both died after being taken to the hospital,” Ghanshyam said in his complaint.

“An FIR has been filed against the truck driver and a search is underway. The accused driver will be arrested soon,” the Faridabad police spokesperson said.

Noida workers protest Two more arrested over violence

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NOIDA: Gautam Buddh Nagar police has arrested two more accused in connection with the recent violence during protests by workers in Noida, officials said on Monday.

The accused, identified as Himanshu Thakur and Satyam Verma, were arrested on Sunday and are alleged to have been involved in orchestrating provocative activities and violence during the protests.

According to the police, both were active members of ‘Bigul Mazdoor Dasta’ and played a role in mobilising and inciting demonstrators during the sit-ins held under the jurisdiction of the Phase-2 police station, where a case in connection with the incidents has already been registered.

Thakur, currently residing in north Delhi, was present in Noida on the day of the incident and was in constant con-



tact with Aditya Anand, the alleged mastermind behind the unrest, the police said.

The arrests were made after sustained interrogation and investigation by the police, officials added.

Further legal proceedings against the accused are underway.

Noida police and UP Special Task Force, which is also handling the case, had on April 18 announced the arrest of the protest’s “mastermind” Aditya Anand from Tiruchirappalli in Tamil Nadu.

According to the police, during the factory workers’ protest for a wage hike on April 13, “misleading posts” were circulated through some social media accounts with the intent to disturb public peace and law and order. A mob subsequently resorted to stone-pelting, arson and vandalism, targeting vehicles, private property and public assets.

Multiple FIRs were registered under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and the Information Technology Act.

JNUSU seeks release of arrested JNU students

NEW DELHI: The Jawaharlal Nehru University Students’ Union (JNUSU) has condemned the arrest of several student activists, including JNU scholar Akhilesh Yadav, describing it as an “attack on democratic dissent” and demanding their immediate release.

In a statement, the union expressed solidarity with those detained — Rahul Singh Kajla, Deependra Dwivedi, Satyam Kushwaha and Neeraj — who were reportedly protesting against remarks made about Congress leader Rahul Gandhi by journalist Ashok Srivastava of Doodardarshan News.

JNUSU alleged that the arrests reflect a pattern of

suppressing dissent through “intimidation, detention and legal harassment”. It cited earlier incidents, including the incarceration of the “JNU-14” during protests against the UGC Equity Bill and the Rohith Act, as part of a broader clampdown on student activism.

The union warned that police action against peaceful protesters risks creating a climate of fear and undermines democratic accountability. It stressed that disagreement and critique are essential to public discourse. Calling for accountability, JNUSU urged authorities to prioritise dialogue over force and reiterated its demand for the immediate release of all detained activists.

MPPOST

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a suspected case of custodial death, a 34-year-old man died after his health deteriorated while at a police station in northwest Delhi’s Jahangirpuri area, with a preliminary medical opinion suggesting dehydration as the cause, police said on Monday.

The incident occurred in the early hours of Sunday when Anish, a resident of Bhalswa Dairy, was picked up by patrolling staff on the basis of suspicion and taken to a police station for verification.

According to officials, Anish was brought to the police station around 3:30 am during routine night patrolling. “While at the station, he complained of uneasiness and was given water. However, his condition worsened and he began experiencing breathlessness,” a senior police officer said.

The officer said on his request, police personnel immediately shifted Anish to the Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial (BJRM) Hospital, where he died during treatment.

Police said an initial examination and the medico-legal case (MLC) report did not reveal any external injury or mark of assault on the body. This was also corroborated by the police staff present at the station at the time, including the sentry on duty.

“Anish is survived by his family and was married. He worked with his father at the Azadpur Sabzi Mandi. A preliminary medical opinion has suggested dehydration as the cause of death,” the officer said.

Police said the deceased was in a weakened state and was suffering from an illness. He also had a history of substance abuse and reportedly been consuming alcohol continuously



KEY POINTS

- » According to officials, Anish was brought to the police station around 3:30 am during routine night patrolling
- » ‘While at the station, he complained of uneasiness and was given water. However, his condition worsened and he began experiencing breathlessness,’ a senior police officer said
- » On his request, police personnel immediately shifted Anish to the Babu Jagjivan Ram Memorial (BJRM) Hospital, where he died during treatment: Police officer

for the last few days, as stated by his family members.

Authorities said the exact cause of death will be confirmed after the post-mortem. Inquest proceedings have been initiated in accordance with legal provisions and further investigation is underway. Police said all procedures are being conducted with due transparency and in accordance with the law. A police source said a team of senior officers will conduct an inquiry into the matter.

News at a glance

WOMAN KILLED, HUSBAND HURT IN STABBING

NEW DELHI: A woman was killed and her husband critically injured in a stabbing near TPT Centre Jhuggi in Azadpur’s Adarsh Nagar area of northwest Delhi on Saturday night. Police received a PCR call at around 9:01 PM and found Ashu injured, who was shifted to hospital, while his wife Rakhi was declared brought dead. The incident reportedly followed a dispute after three youths allegedly snatched the couple’s son’s mobile phone. Police have identified the suspects and launched a manhunt. Further investigation is underway.

CYBER FRAUD RACKET BUSTED IN SHAHDARA

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police Cyber Cell has busted a cyber fraud racket in Shahdara linked to fake online trading schemes, arresting two accused and recovering key digital evidence. The accused, Abhishek (23) and Sumit (22) from Bijnor, Uttar Pradesh, allegedly duped a Delhi resident of 2 lakh after initially showing fake profits to gain trust through WhatsApp messages. The victim was later persuaded to invest a larger amount, after which communication stopped.

GGM AUTHORITIES RECLAIM RS 25 CR LAND

GURUGRAM: Gurugram Metropolitan Development Authority (GMDA), along with police, reclaimed around half an acre of government land in Sector 63 on Monday that was allegedly encroached by a criminal, officials said. The land, valued at about Rs 25 crore, was reportedly used by Nitesh to build around 50 illegal huts and run unauthorised activities, including scrap godowns and borewells.

ORDERS DRAINAGE OVERHAUL IN AZADPUR

CM inspects North Delhi, flags open drains, cleanliness lapses

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday inspected areas near Azadpur in north Delhi and reprimanded officials after finding open drains and a lack of cleanliness.

During the inspection, Gupta was accompanied by officials from the Delhi Metro, the Public Works Department and the Municipal Corporation of Delhi.

“For the people of Delhi, we are developing better infrastructure and facilities according to their needs,” Gupta said, adding that new development works have been initiated even in areas neglected for years.

The chief minister directed PWD to undertake a comprehensive reconstruction of the drainage system in Azadpur, Adarsh Nagar and Tripolia



CM Rekha Gupta, front centre, during an inspection, in New Delhi PTI

Chowk under the new Drainage master plan.

Gupta emphasised that all works must adhere to “three non-negotiables -- transparency, strict timelines and uncompromised quality -- to ensure that citizens receive

intended benefits without delay.”

“At Azadpur Chowk, CM assessed the strength and quality of pillars and expressed strong concern over any shortcomings. She directed that footpaths affected by pil-

KEY POINTS

» Gupta emphasised that all works must adhere to ‘three non-negotiables -- transparency, strict timelines, uncompromised quality -- to ensure citizens receive intended benefits without delay

» ‘She directed that footpaths affected by pillar construction must be restored immediately to their original condition once work is completed’

lar construction must be restored immediately to their original condition once work is completed, reiterating that inconvenience to the public is unacceptable,” a statement from the chief minister office said. Gupta further instructed

that proper drainage arrangements at construction sites must be ensured to prevent water accumulation, and that agencies must maintain close coordination particularly with the PWD to deliver projects with full transparency and within stipulated deadlines.

She underlined that there will be “zero compromise” on safety standards, construction quality and site hygiene.

The chief minister instructed the departments concerned to complete all work with full transparency, within the timeline and without compromising on quality.

During the review of the construction work at Azadpur Metro station, the chief minister gave necessary instructions to the concerned officials regarding cleanliness, garbage collection, and better management, the statement added.

Capital proposes 108 PG, DNB, & Fellowship seats

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant move to strengthen medical education and healthcare delivery, the Delhi government has proposed 108 postgraduate (PG), Diplomate of National Board (DNB), and Fellowship seats across 10 government medical and teaching institutions. The proposal, led by the Health Department, aims to create a larger pool of specialised doctors and improve patient care across the capital.

The initiative comes under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the guidance of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta. Officials said the expansion is designed to strengthen both academic capacity and healthcare infrastructure in Delhi.

Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh described the move as a key step towards improving healthcare outcomes. He said, “The expansion of PG, DNB, and Fellowship seats is a significant step towards strengthening Delhi’s

“These seats will help in training a robust pool of highly skilled and specialised doctors, ensuring better patient care and improved health outcomes for Delhiites”

healthcare ecosystem. These seats will help in training a robust pool of highly skilled and specialised doctors, ensuring better patient care and improved health outcomes for the citizens of Delhi.”

According to the proposal, 67 seats have been earmarked for MD/MS programmes, 36 for DNB courses, and 5 for Fellowship programmes, ensuring a balanced expansion across different streams of medical specialisation.

Among institutions, Maulana Azad Medical College has been allocated 35 MD/MS

seats, while Dr. Baba Saheb Ambedkar Medical College will receive 24 MD/MS seats. Indira Gandhi Medical College has been allotted 18 DNB seats, followed by Deep Chand Bandhu Hospital with 8 DNB seats.

Guru Teg Bahadur Hospital has been allocated 2 DNB seats along with 3 Fellowship positions, while University College of Medical Sciences, in association with GTB Hospital, will receive 4 MD/MS seats.

Guru Gobind Singh Government Hospital has been allotted 2 DNB seats, Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital 4 DNB seats, and Bhagwan Mahavir Hospital 2 DNB seats. Additionally, Delhi State Cancer Institute will receive 4 MD/MS seats along with 2 Fellowship positions.

Officials noted that this expansion is expected to significantly enhance advanced medical training capacity in Delhi and contribute to building a stronger, more resilient public healthcare system.

MCD implements revised pollution charges for trucks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has said it would immediately implement the revised environment compensation charges (ECC) for commercial vehicles entering the city, in line with a recent order of the Supreme Court.

The revised rates, aimed at discouraging polluting vehicles, have significantly increased across categories, according to officials.

According to the order, for Category 2 vehicles (light commercial vehicles) and Category 3 vehicles (two-axle trucks), the ECC has been raised from Rs 1,400 to Rs 2,000.

For heavier vehicles, the

charges have seen a steeper hike. Category 4 vehicles (three-axle trucks) and Category 5 vehicles (four-axle trucks and above) will now be charged Rs 4,000, up from Rs 2,600.

Officials said the revision follows the Supreme Court’s directions in the MC Mehta vs Union of India case, which called for higher ECC rates to curb vehicular pollution in the national capital.

The ECC is a fee levied on commercial vehicles entering Delhi to curb air pollution, over and above existing toll charges. Around 4,000 trucks enter the capital daily, with higher rates aimed at discouraging heavier, more polluting vehicles and reducing vehicular emissions.

Delhi issues comprehensive SOP under Section 33 to curb tree-related offences

AIMAN FATIMA



ing accountability in every case.

The SOP introduces a robust rapid response system, enabling citizens to lodge complaints through a toll-free helpline, online portal, and offline channels. All complaints will be transmitted in real time to field officers, ensuring prompt action. Quick Response Teams at headquarters and divisional levels will reach sites within a stipulated time to prevent further damage and gather evidence through geo-tagged photographs and

videos.

Strengthening enforcement, officials including Beat Officers and Tree Officers have been empowered to issue prohibitory orders, seize equipment used in offences, and coordinate with law enforcement agencies. To ensure round-the-clock monitoring, dedicated control rooms have been established at headquarters and divisional levels, functioning 24x7.

Highlighting citizen participation, the Chief Minister

“To ensure round-the-clock monitoring, dedicated control rooms have been established at headquarters and divisional levels, functioning 24x7”

announced the reactivation of the Green Helpline and portal to facilitate easy complaint registration and tracking. Emphasising strict action, she said, “Violation of tree protection laws will not be tolerated under any circumstances.”

Reaffirming the government’s commitment, she noted that the initiative aligns with the vision of sustainable development and urged citizens to actively report violations to protect Delhi’s green assets.

Dehradun institute to submit report on low survival rate of transplanted trees in Capital

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: The Forest Research Institute in Dehradun, which was tasked to study the reasons for the low survival rate of transplanted trees in Delhi, will submit its interim report in six months, with the final report due in 12 months.

The study will span a total period of one year from the release of the first instalment of the sanctioned budget, a source in the department said, adding that Rs 30 lakh has been allocated for the exercise.

“The interim report will focus on a review of existing literature and documented

“The forest dept data also showed that of 1,357 trees transplanted between 2019 and 2022, only 578 survived”

data on tree transplantation, while the final report will present detailed findings based on field assessments and scientific analysis,” the source added.

PTI had earlier reported that the institute was tasked with identifying the reasons behind the poor survival of transplanted trees, with the findings expected to help make changes to the Delhi Tree Transplantation Policy, 2020.

The move comes amid concerns over low survival rates. A previous report by FRI estimated an overall survival rate of 35.45 per cent, with variation across species.

The forest department data also showed that of 1,357 trees transplanted between 2019 and 2022, only 578 survived, translating to a survival rate of 42.5 per cent.

Delhi Environment and Forest Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa earlier told PTI

that the study is aimed at making the transplantation process more effective. “We are conducting this study to understand why transplantation has faced persistent challenges over the years. The findings will help us adopt a more scientific approach based on field evidence and expert inputs, and make the city greener,” he said.

In a recent meeting, the forest department noted that species such as ‘papdi’, ‘sheesham’, ‘lasoda’, ‘desi kikar’, ‘khejri’, ‘ronjh’, ‘bakain’ and ‘ashoka’ with girth above 200 cm tend to have poor survival rates and may be avoided.

It also stressed that post-

transplantation maintenance is a key factor and suggested that agencies be made responsible for upkeep for at least two to three years to improve survival outcomes. The meeting further recommended reviewing the requirement of transplanting 80 per cent of affected trees, noting that the target may not be feasible in all cases due to on-ground constraints.

Under the Tree Transplantation Policy, 2020, tree transplantation is mandatory in unavoidable development projects. It includes site surveys, tree preservation plans, pruning, root ball preparation, relocation, and replanting.

audit findings must translate into tangible improvements on the ground. He emphasized that Delhi’s response to air pollution must move beyond incremental steps to address structural gaps.

The PAC report highlights several systemic issues, including weaknesses in regulatory frameworks, enforcement mechanisms, and institutional coordination. It points to gaps in air quality monitoring infrastructure, incomplete tracking of pollutants, and lack of reliable emission data, which hinder evidence-based policymaking.

The Speaker also flagged challenges in public transport, noting shortages of buses, limited route coverage, and inadequate last-mile connectivity. Delays in route rationalisation and slow adoption of alternative transport systems have contributed to increased reliance on private vehicles, worsening congestion and pollution levels.

NDMC identifies pigeon, stray dogs feeding points and ramps up sanitation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council has submitted a compliance report before the National Green Tribunal detailing action to regulate the feeding of pigeons, monkeys, cattle and stray dogs, and to address related sanitation concerns, officials said on Monday.

According to the report filed on Friday, the civic body has identified pigeon feeding points in its area and directed the staff to regularly penalise people causing insanitary conditions.

“In the last three months to identify locations of pigeon feeding points, 23 challans were done in January 2026, 14 in February 2026 and 39 in March 2026, and directions were issued to challan regularly the persons creating insanitary conditions,” the report stated, adding that the enforcement department has also removed unauthorised vendors from the concerned areas.

Steps underway to curb monkey and cattle feeding: MCD

Daily cleaning is also being carried out at such locations, the officials said.

Regarding stray dogs, the NDMC said it has taken steps through the Palika ABC Society to regulate feeding. Around 100 designated feeding points have been identified and 100 instruction boards installed.

Awareness campaigns have been conducted with resident welfare associations, and regular monitoring is being carried out to ensure compliance, the report said. Several steps to stop monkey and cattle feeding and maintaining cleanliness are being carried out, they said.

Awareness drives, including nukkad natak and social media campaigns, were held. Over 2,000 monkeys were trapped and rehabilitated, four challans issued.

Delhi govt mandates rainwater harvesting to tackle water crisis

Over 60 departments tasked with rainwater harvesting rollout

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a major move to tackle water scarcity and urban flooding, the Delhi government has made rainwater harvesting mandatory across the city, with Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh leading a coordinated push involving over 60 departments. The decision was taken during a high-level meeting at the Delhi Secretariat, marking a shift towards stricter enforcement and accountability.

The initiative aligns with Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s vision of “Catch the Rain, where it falls, when it falls,” aiming to turn water conservation into a mass movement. Officials said the policy will help address both water shortages during summers and waterlogging during monsoons.

Addressing the meeting, the Minister highlighted the need



for urgent action, stating, “For four months every year, rainwater flows through our drains and goes to waste.

“If we channel this water into the ground, we can recharge our groundwater and reduce the crisis we face every summer.”

All departments have been assigned time-bound targets to install functional rainwater harvesting systems in government buildings, parks, residen-

TAKEAWAYS

» Addressing the meeting, Minister Parvesh Verma highlighted the need for urgent action, stating, ‘For four months every year, rainwater flows through our drains and goes to waste. If we channel this water into the ground, we can recharge our groundwater and reduce the crisis we face every summer’

» All depts have been assigned time-bound targets to install functional rainwater harvesting systems in government buildings, parks, residential colonies, and institutional campuses before the monsoon

tial colonies, and institutional campuses before the monsoon. Emphasising accountability, he said, “Every department has been assigned responsibility... if systems are not installed, they must be put in place immediately.”

The Delhi Jal Board will play a key role in implementation and monitoring, along with financial incentives.

“Delhi Jal Board will share part of the cost and provide a

10 per cent rebate where rainwater harvesting systems are functional,” the Minister said, adding that non-compliance could lead to withdrawal of benefits.

He also stressed stricter enforcement, noting, “Till now, there was a rule but no real checking. That will change.”

Calling for collective action, he said, “This cannot be left to the government alone... Water is a shared responsibility.”

FOR SETTING UP COURTS

SC asks states, UTs to provide details of pending terror and drugs cases

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday asked all states and union territories to provide details of terror and narcotics cases being probed by Central and state agencies, including the NIA and the NCB, as a step towards setting up special exclusive courts for early disposal of the cases.

The top court asked the Centre to consider providing funds of Rs 1 crore each for setting up the courts in all states and UTs to prosecute cases lodged under the UAPA (the Unlawful Activities [Prevention] Act) and the NDPS Act (the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act).

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joyimalye Bagchi also asked Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati, appearing for the Centre, to consider releas-

Highlights

- » The top court asked the Centre to consider providing funds of Rs 1 crore each for setting up the courts in all states and UTs to prosecute cases lodged under the UAPA Act and the NDPS Act
- » The bench highlighted that early disposal would balance the rights of the accused and victims both
- » The bench had identified 17 states where more than 10 NIA trials are currently pending

ing Rs 1 crore annually for ensuring smooth functioning of the special courts.

The suo motu case was fixed for further hearing on May 8.

On March 24, the apex court directed the establishment of special courts for cases investigated by the National Investigation Agency and those falling under the UAPA. Expanding the ambit, the CJI on Monday asked advocate generals of 17 states to furnish the details of cases lodged under the UAPA

and the NDPS Act, irrespective of whether they are prosecuted by the NIA or the state police and by Narcotics Control Bureau or by state agencies.

The bench highlighted that early disposal would balance the rights of the accused and victims both.

The bench also issued notices to the remaining states and asked them to furnish the requisite information.

The suo motu petition was initiated following concerns

that NIA trials were languishing for years.

The court noted that in many of the 17 high pendency states, including Delhi, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Bihar and Jammu and Kashmir, special courts were overburdened because presiding officers were also assigned non-NIA cases.

“NIA Courts should exclusively deal with UAPA or other related trials and such Presiding Officers should not be entrusted with any other cases,” the bench said.

A Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) Office Memorandum of January 7, 2026 outlined a robust financial framework for these courts. It said the Central government will provide an annual grant of up to Rs 1 crore per court for staff salaries and office expenses.

It also provided for one-time non-recurring limit of Rs 1 crore for infrastructure ren-

ovation, IT equipment (computers, broadband, etc.), and furniture.

The MHA had said each court will follow a specific “model staff pattern”, including a special judge, stenographers and a dedicated driver with a vehicle for the presiding officer.

The bench had identified 17 states where more than 10 NIA trials are currently pending. The 17 states are Assam, Bihar, Chhattisgarh, Delhi, Gujarat, Jammu & Kashmir, Jharkhand, Karnataka, Kerala, Maharashtra, Manipur, Punjab, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Andhra Pradesh, Rajasthan, and Telangana. They agreed to set up at least one exclusive court as a pilot project.

The bench further directed the chief justices of the respective high courts to fast-track the appointment of judges with “fair and reasonable experience in conducting criminal trials”.

Govt reviews rural schemes; Rs 17,744 cr for MGNREGA wages

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government has reviewed preparedness of rural welfare and infrastructure programmes in view of the potential impact of the West Asia situation on supply chains and prices, and said that MGNREGA rural employment scheme will continue uninterrupted with Rs 17,744 crore being released towards wage payments.

In an official statement, the Ministry of Rural Development said it is closely monitoring developments that may have indirect implications for rural livelihoods, housing construction, road development and watershed activities, while ensuring continuity of benefits, timely fund flow and smooth execution of schemes.

The Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme (MGNREGA) will remain fully operational till the proposed VB-G RAM G Act, 2025, comes into force, with no disruption in wage employment, it said.

All statutory entitlements, including demand-based work and timely wage payments, will continue without dilution and existing wage rates will remain applicable.

The proposed VB-G RAM G Act will enhance the employment guarantee to 125 days, with revised wage rates to be notified separately.

The specific operating guidelines for VB-G RAM G are currently being drafted. Until these rules are officially notified, MGNREGA remains in full effect to ensure rural households face no interruption in their guaranteed work.

On the rural housing, the ministry said it is implementing the Pradhan Mantri Awaas Yojana Gramin to construct 4.95 crore houses by March 2029.

Measures such as timely direct benefit transfers, real-time monitoring through AwaasSoft, geo-tagging and faster completion of ongoing houses are being prioritised to address possible supply disruptions or price fluctuations.

No evidence of air crash in Chhattisgarh's Jashpur: Officials

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JASHPUR: No evidence of an aircraft crash has been found in Chhattisgarh's Jashpur so far, the district authorities clarified on Monday.

The clarification came amidst reports of a suspected air crash in a hilly terrain in the district, which kept the local administration and police on their toes in the afternoon.

Claims of a crash gained traction after a video showing smoke rising from a hill, along with a picture of an aircraft, in the Narayanpur area, went viral on social media.

Several news channels and web portals went on to report it as a crash incident.

Acting on the reports, District Collector Rohit Vyas and Senior Superintendent of Police Lal Umend Singh rushed to the spot, and a search operation was launched around 3 pm.

From Page 1 Uncertainty

The statement came as both sides were poised to land in Islamabad for the second round of talks, which seems intact given the security arrangement that virtually sealed off the Red Zone, where key offices and buildings, including the Serena and Marriott hotels, are located.

The last round of dialogue was held on April 11 and 12 at Serena, which has been vacated along with the Marriott for the second round.

Pakistan's Interior Minister Mohsin Naqvi met separately with the envoys of the US and Iran on Monday to discuss security and other arrangements for the expected second round of talks.

Pakistan has undertaken elaborate security arrangements along with diplomatic efforts to facilitate direct talks between the two warring sides in a bid to end the conflict.

According to a statement, Naqvi discussed “arrangements for a second round of Islamabad Talks” with Iran's Ambassador to Pakistan Reza Amir Moghadam, telling him that the preparations were complete.

“Pak-Iran relations span decades. We view [these] brotherly relations with an eye of esteem,” Naqvi said, adding that Pakistan was in favour of “resolving the US-Iran conflict through negotiations.” He also said the enduring solution to the conflict is the guarantor of the region's stability and peace. More than 10,000 security personnel have been deployed in Islamabad.

So far, there is no change in Trump's announcement on Sunday that his team would land in Islamabad. “My Representatives are going to Islamabad, Pakistan — They will be there tomorrow evening (Monday), for Negotiations,” he posted on Truth Social.

Last time, Vice President JD Vance led the talks while Ghalibaf led the Iranian side.

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif dialled Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian late Sunday and reaffirmed his country's “sincere” efforts to advance regional peace and security.

Sharif apprised the Iranian President about his recent engagements with several world leaders, including those from Saudi Arabia, Qatar and Türkiye.

These interactions were most helpful in building consensus in support of a sustained process of dialogue and diplomacy, aimed at bringing lasting peace to the war-ravaged region, he said.

In the leadup and throughout the seven-week war, Trump has

faced criticism from the left and from some of his own supporters that he followed Israel's lead into launching the conflict.

But Trump on social media is blaming the media for pushing what he claims is a false narrative. “Israel never talked me into the war with Iran, the results of Oct. 7th, added to my lifelong opinion that IRAN CAN NEVER HAVE A NUCLEAR WEAPON,” Trump posted.

Trump says Vance is en route to Pakistan, but it's not clear where the VP actually is.

The New York Post quoted Trump in an interview claiming that Vice President JD Vance is headed to Pakistan for negotiations on the Iran War, along with special envoy Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner, who is Trump's son-in-law. “They're heading over now,” Trump said. “They'll be there tonight.”

But it's not quite clear if Trump was speaking more broadly or if the claims about Vance are accurate. Administration officials have in response to questions declined to confirm if Vance is, in fact, mid-air on the way to Islamabad, the capital of Pakistan.

MEA

so that we can have a safe exit of our ships through the Strait of Hormuz. In this effort, 10 of our ships have so far safely crossed the Strait of Hormuz.... One ship is to reach, it will happen soon, as my colleague gave you details of that,” Jaiswal said.

“When the firing incident happened, this happened on Saturday, two of our ships came under firing. When this matter was reported to us, we took it up very strongly. We called in the Iranian ambassador, he had a meeting with the foreign secretary. The foreign secretary conveyed our deep concerns on the incident and also reiterated the point that we have been making,” he said.

The MEA spokesperson said India attaches very high importance to the safety and security of its mariners and commercial shipping.

“And that there should be uninterrupted transit through the Strait of Hormuz. So, these points were put forth. The ambassador was told that this may be conveyed to authorities back home. We continue to be in touch with the Iranian authorities for the safety of our ships, for their safe exit through the Strait of Hormuz,” he added.

Shipping Corporation of India (SCI) tanker is the 10th India-flagged vessel to have crossed the strait since early March, authorities said earlier.

Crude oil tanker Desh Garima, with 31 Indian seafarers onboard, crossed the strategic waterway on

April 18 and is expected to reach Mumbai on April 22, they said.

Additional Secretary (Gulf), MEA, Aseem R Mahajan said flights continue to operate from the region to India from countries where airspace is open.

Since February 28, around 11.3 lakh passengers have travelled from the region to India, he said.

The West Asia conflict has stretched for over 50 days.

“Israel airspace is open, and limited flight operations have resumed to destinations in the region, which can be used for onward travel to India. We also continue to facilitate travel of Indian nationals from Israel, through Jordan and Egypt to India,” the statement said. AGENCIES

Kejriwal

institution without any basis, as a personal attack on a judge is an attack on the judiciary itself.

Justice Sharma concluded that the narrative in the pleas for her recusal was based on conjectures and “perceived inclinations”.

“This court will stand up for itself and the institution.... I will not recuse,” the judge said.

Kejriwal had raised several objections against the judge hearing the Central Bureau of Investigation's (CBI) plea against his discharge in the liquor-policy case, including that she had earlier denied him relief on his petition challenging his arrest and refused to grant relief on the bail pleas of other accused, including Manish Sisodia and K Kavitha.

Besides Kejriwal, the applications for the judge's recusal were also filed by Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leaders Sisodia and Durgesh Pathak. Other respondents, including Vijay Nair and Arun Ramchandra Pillai, had also sought her recusal.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta appeared in the court for the CBI and opposed the plea. He had earlier urged Justice Sharma to initiate contempt action against Kejriwal and the others for seeking her recusal.

On February 27, the trial court had discharged Kejriwal, Sisodia and others in the Delhi liquor-policy case, saying the CBI's case was wholly unable to survive judicial scrutiny and stood discredited in its entirety. WITH AGENCY INPUTS

J&K; 21 dead

Fifteen passengers were found dead at the scene. Four more died later at a hospital. Two critically injured individuals subsequently succumbed at Udhampur District Hospital, bringing the total death toll to 21.

Among those who lost their

lives were Tilo Ram, Prem Nath, Kartar Chand, Som Raj, Ram Chand, Gita Devi, Romal Singh, Sharda Devi, Sunny, Vishali Devi, Pushap Raj, Ramolo Ram, Gulabo Devi, Jalam Singh, Kesar Singh, Kanta Devi and Anita Devi, all residents of Ramnagar.

An Army convoy happened to be passing through the area when the accident occurred, and soldiers immediately took charge of rescue operations. “I was leading the convoy when the accident occurred on the way. The vehicle fell from a height of nearly 100 metres. We immediately secured the area and launched the rescue operations, thus saving many precious lives with great difficulty,” said the Army soldier who led the response. Locals also extended significant help during the effort. A hydraulic crane was eventually brought in to straighten the wreckage.

Deputy Inspector General of Police, Udhampur-Reasi Range, Shiv Kumar Sharma, who was present at the site, said the tragedy had shaken everyone. “This was a very tragic incident and we stand in solidarity with the families who have lost their loved ones. The Jammu and Kashmir Police stands with them in this hour of grief,” he said.

Of the 51 injured, 43 are admitted to Udhampur District Hospital and six to a hospital in Ramnagar. Two of the most critical patients have been transferred to Government Medical College in Jammu for specialised care.

Chief Secretary Atal Dulloo, speaking at Udhampur District Hospital, called the incident deeply painful and pointed to the need for stronger enforcement of road safety rules. “It must be ensured that there is no overloading, vehicles are in good condition, drivers have valid licences and their medical fitness is verified,” he said.

President Droupadi Murmu and Prime Minister Narendra Modi both offered condolences. Modi announced an ex-gratia of Rs 2 lakh for families of each person killed and Rs 50,000 for those injured. Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah matched the announcement for the deceased and added Rs 1 lakh for the seriously injured and Rs 25,000 for those with minor injuries. Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha directed district administration, police, the SDRF and health department to extend every possible assistance.

“The government stands firmly with the victims and their families in this hour of grief, and that all necessary assistance is being extended,” Abdullah wrote on X.

Union minister Jitendra Singh, who represents Udhampur in the Lok Sabha, also condoled the tragedy and is expected to visit the injured in hospital on Tuesday evening.

JEE-Main results

of all those who appeared for the examination in one shift. The marks obtained are transformed into a scale ranging from 100 to 0 for each shift of examinees.

“The NTA score is not the same as the percentage of marks obtained,” a senior official explained. AGENCIES

Heatwave

heatwave, including ensuring electricity supply for a projected peak demand of about 34,500 megawatts. All thermal power plants are operating at full capacity, while the replacement of old meters with smart meters has been paused to maintain stability.

He said authorities are arranging water sprinkling on roads, shaded public spaces, health camps at construction and industrial sites, and dedicated treatment facilities for heatstroke patients. Free drinking water is being made available at tehsils, farms, hospitals and anganwadi centres. Measures are also being implemented to safeguard livestock and wildlife, including heat action plans in zoos and sanctuaries.

Temperatures across Uttar Pradesh have already surged. Prayagraj recorded 44.4 degrees Celsius, while Varanasi touched 44 degrees. Banda reported 43 degrees and Sultanpur 43.3 degrees. Cities such as Kanpur, Gorakhpur, Jhansi, Agra and Aligarh registered maximum temperatures between 40 and 43 degrees Celsius, all above normal levels. In Delhi, the maximum temperature reached 39.5 degrees Celsius, 2.7 degrees above average, with the minimum at 22.8 degrees.

Neighbouring states are also experiencing intense heat. Rajasthan's Kota recorded 42 degrees Celsius, while Barmer, Alwar and Chittorgarh all crossed 41 degrees. Haryana's Narnaul touched 42 degrees, nearly five degrees above normal, and Punjab's Bathinda recorded 41 degrees. Chandigarh reported a high of 38.1 degrees, three degrees above normal.

In Jharkhand, authorities have revised school timings under a yellow alert for heatwave conditions from April 20 to 22. Students up to Class 8 will attend classes from 7 am to 11.30 am, while senior students will continue till noon. Districts including Garhwa, Palamu, Chatra, Latehar, Bokaro and Dhanbad are among the most affected.

In sharp contrast, Assam faced a different extreme. Torrential overnight rain inundated Guwahati, submerging roads and homes and bringing traffic to a standstill. The state disaster management authority reported that a woman died after falling into a drain at Maligaon Chariali near the Northeast Frontier Railway headquarters. Water levels reached knee-deep on most roads and rose to chest height in some areas, leaving vehicles stranded and ambulances delayed for hours. Power outages were also reported across several localities.

Separately, Assam has sought an extension of its interim bail, citing medical concerns, and sought an urgent consideration on April 15 as the existing relief nears expiry.

However, the High Court declined, saying that the bail application would be taken up as per the schedule fixed by the registry.

India, South Korea push peace message, target to double trade to \$50 billion by 2030

Continued from Page 1
Future growth and resilience.

Modi said the current bilateral trade of \$27 billion could be significantly scaled up through “several important decisions” taken during the visit. “We have taken several important decisions today to take this to \$50 billion by 2030,” he said, adding that the partnership would evolve across domains ranging “from chips to ships, from talent to technology, and from environment to energy.”

A key outcome of the visit was the decision to resume negotiations to upgrade the Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement, which has been in force since 2010. The revised framework is expected to address existing bottlenecks and create new opportunities for businesses in both countries. To facilitate this, the two sides also launched an India-Korea Financial Forum and agreed to establish an Industrial Cooperation Committee to support business engagement.

In a move aimed at strengthening industrial ties, Modi announced the creation of a Korean Industrial Township in India, designed to ease the entry of South Korean companies, particularly small and medium enterprises. An “Economic Security Dialogue” was also launched to enhance coordination on critical technologies and supply chains, reflecting growing concerns over global disruptions.

The leaders unveiled a joint strategic vision for their special strategic partnership and released a comprehensive framework focused on shipbuilding, shipping, and maritime logistics. According to officials, the initiative will involve upgrading existing shipyards, developing block fabrication facilities, and constructing new dry docks capable of handling large and specialised vessels. Plans also include cooperation on next-generation maritime equipment, including autonomous port systems. Energy security emerged as another priority area, with both sides issuing a joint statement outlining their intent to cooperate more closely in ensuring stable and reliable energy supplies. In parallel, a foreign ministerial-level framework was introduced to expand dialogue on climate change, Arctic issues, and maritime cooperation.

The talks also touched on regional and global security concerns. Modi and

Lee discussed the West Asia crisis, the Russia-Ukraine conflict, and broader geopolitical contestations. Indian officials indicated that both countries see value in working together to strengthen multilateral institutions and promote stability.

President Lee described the planned upgrade of the economic partnership as a “new engine for shared growth,” and his visit, which began Sunday and spans three days, was portrayed by both sides as a turning point in bilateral relations. Modi said the visit had laid the foundation for the “next decade of success stories,” adding that the partnership would become more “dynamic and wide-ranging.”

The two countries reiterated their shared vision for a peaceful, stable, and inclusive Indo-Pacific region, a stance that comes amid increasing Chinese assertiveness. “In this period of global tensions, India and Korea together convey a message of peace and stability,” Modi said, adding that their joint efforts would contribute to a “peaceful, progressive, and inclusive Indo-Pacific.”

Officials also noted discussions on nonproliferation and the safeguarding of sensitive technologies from non-state actors and sanctioned entities. South Korea acknowledged India's support for the denuclearisation of the Korean Peninsula, reflecting convergence on key security concerns.

Beyond strategic and economic matters, both leaders highlighted longstanding cultural ties. Modi referred to the historical connection between Princess Suriratna of Ayodhya and King Kim Suro, dating back two millennia, as part of a shared heritage. He also pointed to the growing popularity of Korean pop culture in India and rising interest in Indian cinema in South Korea.

To further strengthen people-to-people ties, the two countries plan to organise an India-Korea Friendship Festival in 2028. Modi noted that President Lee himself is an admirer of Indian cinema, describing cultural exchange as an important pillar of the relationship. Framing the partnership in broader terms, Modi said democratic values, respect for the rule of law, and commitment to a market economy form the “DNA” of both nations, providing a strong foundation for deeper cooperation in the years ahead.

SEXUAL ASSAULT ON MINOR

Raj HC reserves order on Asaram's plea challenging conviction

OUR CORRESPONDENT

JODHPUR: The Rajasthan High Court on Monday reserved its order on an appeal by self-styled godman Asaram against his conviction and life sentence in a case of sexual assault of a minor.

A trial court in Jodhpur had in April 2018 sentenced Asaram, 85, to imprisonment

for the remainder of his natural life in the case.

A division bench of Justices Arun Monga and Yogendra Kumar Purohit concluded marathon hearings after final submissions from both sides. The proceedings were conducted in a time-bound manner following directions from the Supreme Court in December 2025, which had asked

for the disposal of pending appeals within three months.

Arguments on behalf of the defence concluded earlier this month, while the victim's counsel, P C Solanki, wrapped up rebuttals before the bench resumed the matter on Monday.

Acting on the apex court's instructions, the High Court had scheduled day-to-day

hearings from February 16, making it clear that adjournments would not be routinely granted.

Asaram was arrested in 2013 for allegedly assaulting a minor at his ashram in Manai village near Jodhpur. He was later convicted by a Special POCSO court under the then presiding judge, Madhusudan Sharma.

In the same case, co-accused Shiva and Shilpi were handed 20-year jail terms, while two others, Sharad and Prakash, were acquitted.

Some of the co-accused secured a suspension of sentence and are currently out on bail. Asaram himself has been on temporary bail since October 29, 2025, on medical grounds.

Rahul alleges PM Modi went to Israel complying with Prez Trump’s diktat

‘Nitish was removed as Bihar CM and BJP leader Samrat Choudhary was installed’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

THOOTHUKUDI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Monday alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi visited Israel before the war broke out in Iran, complying with what he was told by US President Donald Trump.

Addressing an election rally here, targeting the BJP, Gandhi reiterated his allegation that “PM Modi will jump if Trump asks him to do so”.

Further, he alleged that before the war in Iran, suddenly Modi was told to go to Israel, and he took a plane, went there and came back. The reason for such behaviour was simple, “Epstein files and Adani,” he alleged.

The Union government had rejected references to PM Modi in the latest Jeffrey Epstein case files, describing it as “little more than trashy ruminations by a convicted criminal that deserves to be dismissed with the utmost contempt”.

Gandhi alleged that US President Donald Trump openly says that PM Modi picks up the phone when he calls and addresses him as, sir and added: “Imagine the Prime



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi addresses a public meeting at Nanguneri ahead of the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections, in Tirunelveli, Monday

Minister of India calling US President Donald Trump, sir.”

Similarly, PM Modi expects the chief minister of Tamil Nadu to be submissive to him and address him as “sir”. However, CM Sta-

lin will never address Modi as sir. So PM Modi wishes to have an AIADMK CM in Tamil Nadu so that he would pick up the phone and say, “Yes sir, what can I do for you?” The BJP wants to have a gov-

Highlights

» Gandhi reiterated his allegation that ‘PM Modi will jump if Trump asks him to do so’

» The Union government had rejected references to PM Modi in the latest Jeffrey Epstein case files

» The old AIADMK that served people is dead and finished.” The AIADMK leaders are “compromised because of their corruption, said Gandhi

» He lauded TN, saying it has shown the way to India for social justice-based development, respecting all communities and traditions

leader Samrat Choudhary was installed in his place.

Slamming RSS-BJP, Rahul Gandhi alleged that they believe India should be “one people, one culture, one religion and one language”. He claimed RSS is essentially an “anti-Tamil, anti-Dravidian organisation”.

He said AIADMK had great leaders who defended Tamil people, and the good old AIADMK that served the people of Tamil Nadu does not exist anymore and alleged that the present-day AIADMK was merely a hollow shell.

“The old AIADMK that served people is dead and finished.” The AIADMK leaders are “compromised because of their corruption.”

The BJP plans to enter Tamil Nadu using the AIADMK.

The AIADMK has dedicated workers, but they do not control the party. People who “control the AIADMK are fully controlled” by Union Home Minister Amit Shah and PM Modi, he alleged.

He lauded Tamil Nadu, saying it has shown the way to India for social justice-based development, respecting all communities and traditions.

Issue wasn’t women’s reservation but govt’s preservation: Congress

Opposition party asserts that women would not be fooled by the ‘BJP propaganda’ on the women’s quota issue

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Monday said the striking down of the Modi government’s delimitation push in the garb of women’s quota was a defeat of “bulldozer politics” and that the Centre’s agenda was not women’s reservation but Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s “preservation”.

The Opposition party also demanded that the Centre immediately implement the women’s quota on the existing Lok Sabha strength by bringing a Bill in Parliament’s Monsoon Session or May-end.

The Congress asserted that women would not be fooled by the “BJP propaganda” on the women’s quota issue as they know that the ruling party wants to push its political agenda in their name.

The Congress’ assertion came days after the government’s Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill to implement women’s quota and increase the number of Lok Sabha seats to 816 was defeated in the Lower House on Friday.

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh told a news agency that the defeat of the government’s “nefarious” designs to push delimitation in the garb

Closer Look

» Opposition party also demanded that the Centre immediately implement women’s quota on existing Lok Sabha strength

» The Bill was not about women’s reservation but one of pushing delimitation through deceit, said Ramesh

of women’s reservation was a victory of the Constitution and democracy.

“It was the defeat of the politics of bulldozer and a rushed delimitation. The Bill was not about women’s reservation but one of pushing delimitation through deceit,” Ramesh said.

He said the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam was passed unanimously in September 2023, but it was not implemented despite Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge demanding that it be implemented from the 2024 general elections.

“Suddenly, the Bill (Act) was notified on the night of 16th April. This reflects the seriousness of the BJP about women’s reservation in legislatures. They kept sleeping for 30 months,”

he added.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah was giving the assurance that no state would lose out and seats would be increased in a manner that the proportionality is maintained, but why was this not part of the Bill, Ramesh asked.

“He (Shah) was asking the Opposition to trust him. How can we trust someone who says something, but the Bill doesn’t mention it in black and white?” the Congress leader asked.

“The issue was not women’s reservation but Modi preservation,” Ramesh told a news agency.

He alleged that the government wants to put the caste census in cold storage.

The Congress reiterates its demand that an all-party meeting be called after April 29, when polling for the second phase of West Bengal polls is over, and the government places before the parties its proposals in writing, he said.

“We demand immediate implementation of women’s reservation in the legislatures on the current strength of the Lok Sabha. The government must bring an amendment bill during the Monsoon session or in May-end if it wants to do it before that,” Ramesh said.

TMC betrayed women by opposing Bill to tweak women’s quota: Nabin

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MAHISHADAL: BJP chief Nitin Nabin on Monday alleged the Trinamool Congress betrayed women by opposing the Centre’s bid to implement women’s quota in legislatures from 2029 and said that had it been a matter of “minorities” reservation, Mamata Banerjee would have walked miles in its support”.

Addressing an election rally in Purba Medinipur’s Mahishadal, he asserted the time has come for the women of the state to punish a government that “protects infiltrators while leaving its own daughters unsafe.”

The BJP national president highlighted the contrast between Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s efforts to provide a 33 per cent quota for women in legislatures and the TMC “obstructing” it.

“While our leader Narendra Modi brought the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam to give women their rightful share in governance, Mamata Didi’s MPs opposed it. Had it been a matter of reservation for minorities, Mamata Didi would have walked miles to support it”

“It is ironic that a state with

‘It is ironic that a state with a woman chief minister sees its daughters humiliated’

a woman chief minister sees its daughters humiliated -- from Sandeshkhali to Joynagar,” Nabin said.

Slamming the ruling TMC, he claimed that women have been the most “oppressed and distressed” under the “Ma, Mati, Manush” government.

If a woman chief minister cannot ensure the safety of womenfolk in her state, she has no moral right to continue in office, the BJP leader said.

Escalating the attack on the TMC’s “appeasement politics”, Nabin alleged the land, which rightfully belongs to the people of Bengal, is being handed over to Bangladeshi infiltrators.

A “double-engine” BJP government in the state would “delete, demote, and deport” illegal immigrants, he said and exuded confidence that people would give a “befitting reply” to “anti-Santan forces” on April 23 and April 29, the days of polling in the state.

BJP committed to women’s quota rollout, Oppn delaying it: Smriti Irani

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Senior BJP leader Smriti Irani on Monday reiterated the party’s commitment to implementing the women’s reservation law, while accusing the TMC and the Congress of adopting a “contradictory” stand and delaying its rollout.

Addressing a press conference here, Irani said Prime Minister Narendra Modi has already made the government’s position clear, which is to ensure the implementation of 33 per cent reservation for women in the Lok Sabha and state Assemblies.

Highlighting the BJP’s internal structure, Irani claimed, “We are a political organisation which has reserved seats for women within the party. Today, women are equal participants even in the Parliamentary board that decides tickets.”

Targeting the Opposition, she questioned their shifting stance on delimitation, a prerequisite for implementing the reservation. “If they supported earlier, why did they suddenly make it an issue during the special session and withdraw support?” she asked, calling it a “serious question” for both the Congress and the TMC.

Irani alleged that the Oppo-



BJP leader Smriti Irani addresses a press conference at a city hotel on Monday.

sition’s position amounted to misleading women.

“Were they deceiving the country then, or are they doing so now?” she said, referring to Congress leader Rahul Gandhi and other Opposition leaders.

Taking aim at West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, Irani said attempts to defer implementation of the women’s reservation amounted to delaying women’s rights. “How long should women of Bengal and the country wait? Irani asked, stating, “This is not just a betrayal of women in Bengal, but of women across the country.”

She countered TMC’s claim of having the highest number of women MPs, stating, “In absolute numbers, the highest representation of women in Parliament is from the NDA.”

Report: 18% candidates in fray in TN have criminal cases, 25% are crorepatis

‘Out of 3,992 candidates analysed, 722 declared criminal cases against themselves’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Around 18 per cent of the candidates in fray in the Tamil Nadu Assembly elections have declared criminal cases against themselves, while 25 per cent have assets worth more than Rs one crore, a report by the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) said on Monday.

According to the report, out of the 3,992 candidates analysed, 722 (18 per cent) candidates have declared criminal cases against themselves. Of these, 404 (10 per cent) have declared serious criminal cases.

In the 2021 Assembly elections, out of 3,559 candidates analysed, 466 (13 per cent) had declared criminal cases against themselves, and 207 (6 per cent) had declared serious criminal cases against themselves.

Among the major parties, 118 (69 per cent) out of 170 candidates analysed from the AIADMK, 92 (40 per cent) out of 231 candidates from the

Key Points

» Among the major parties, 118 (69 per cent) out of 170 candidates analysed from the AIADMK, 92 (40 per cent) out of 231 candidates from the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, 70 (40 per cent) out of 175

candidates analysed from the DMK, 16 (48 per cent) out of 33 from the BJP

» Out of the candidates analysed, 981 (25 per cent) are crorepatis, while 22 (0.55%) are billionaires, meaning they have assets worth Rs 100 crore

the Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam and one (20 per cent) out of five candidates analysed from the CPI have declared serious criminal cases against themselves in their affidavits.

Out of the candidates analysed, 981 (25 per cent) are crorepatis, while 22 (0.55 per cent) are billionaires, meaning they have assets worth Rs 100 crore.

Among the major parties, two (seven per cent) out of 28 candidates analysed from the INC, seven (four per cent) out of 175 candidates analysed from the DMK, three (two per cent) out of 170 candidates analysed from the AIADMK, one (6 per cent) out of 18 candidates analysed from the Pattali Makkal Katchi, one (nine per cent) out of 11 candidates analysed from the Amma Makkal Munnettra Kazagam and eight (three per cent) out of 231 candidates analysed from the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam have declared assets valued more than Rs 100 crore.

Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, 70 (40 per cent) out of 175 candidates analysed from the DMK, 16 (48 per cent) out of 33 from the BJP, 14 (50 per cent) out of 28 candidates analysed from the INC, nine (50 per cent) out of 18 candidates analysed from the Pattali Makkal Katchi, five (50 per cent) out of 10 candidates analysed from the Desiya Murpokku Dravida Kazhagam, three (60 per cent) out of five candidates analysed from the CPI and four (80 per cent) out of five candidates analysed from the CPI(M) have declared criminal cases against them-

selves in their affidavits.

At the same time, 60 (35 per cent) out of 170 candidates analysed from the AIADMK, 43 (19 per cent) out of 231 candidates analysed from the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam, 32 (18 per cent) out of 175 candidates analysed from the DMK, nine (27 per cent) out of 33 candidates analysed from the BJP, five (18 per cent) out of 28 candidates analysed from the INC, six (33 per cent) out of 18 candidates analysed from the Pattali Makkal Katchi, one (10 per cent) out of 10 candidates analysed from

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The customers who are being serviced from the location which is being closed will be serviced from the new location from 15/07/2026 onward.

All the concerned persons are requested to take note of same.

Place: Noida Date: 21/04/2026

Sd/-For Piramal Finance Limited
(Formerly known as Piramal Capital & Housing Finance Limited)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSONS

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused (1) Rashmi Gupta W/o Sanjay Gupta, and (2) Sanjay Gupta S/o Ashok Kumar, Both R/o H.No.526, Shahbad Daulatpur, Delhi have committed (or) are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.341/2015, u/s 420/467/468/471 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi and it have been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Rashmi Gupta and Sanjay Gupta cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Rashmi Gupta and Sanjay Gupta have absconded (or) is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Rashmi Gupta and Sanjay Gupta of FIR No.341/2015, u/s 420/467/468/471 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 26.05.2026.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class
North-West, Court No. 109
1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/5075/RD/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

N.L.T. No. 365135

Name of work with its location

"Comprehensive Maintenance Contract of Vande Bharat Express trainset"

Approx. Cost of work

Tender Cost: Rs.258,47,55,662.29/- including GST (Rs. Two Hundred Fifty Eight Crore Forty Seven Lac Fifty Five Thousand Six Hundred Sixty Two and Paise Twenty Nine Only)

Earnest Money

Rs. 5,16,95,100/-

Completion period of Work

72 months of date of issue of letter of acceptance

Cost of Tender document on cash/bid post

NIL

Pre-Bid conference Date and Time

04.05.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender

Upto 15:00 hrs on 03.06.2026

Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen

Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in

No. 6S-Efile-337396Tender Dated: 28.01.2026 1297/2026

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Section Date

Brake Van Reversal Siding at Asthal Bohar station in Delhi-Rohtak section. 30.04.2026

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD-II Northern Railway, New Delhi

1308/2026

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रौजल ऑफिस: नेताजी मार्ग, मीठाखली छ: रास्ते के पास, एलिस्त्रिज, अहमदाबाद-06. फोन: + 91-79-26421671-75

कृणीओं के लिए मांग सूचना

नीचे बताया गया खाता एन.पी.ए. में परिवर्तित किया गया है और बैंच बैंक द्वारा सिब्युरिटाइज़ेशन एच रिक्न्दरकन ओफ फायनान्सियल एसेट्स एच एफोसेमेन्ट ओफ सिब्युरिटी इन्टरेन्ट एक्ट (थी एक्ट), 2002 की धारा 13 (2) रहल नीचे बताए गए कर्जदारों को रिमान्ड नोटिस जारी की गई थी, जो वापिस आई है। इस लिए आप सभी को और सार्वजनिक जनाता को इस प्रकाशन द्वारा नोटिस जारी की जा रही है।

कृणीओं के नाम और ऋण खाता नं. बैंक संघति (सुखित संघति) का ब्योरा मांग सूचना की तिथि/ NPA की तिथि मांग सूचना की तिथि को बकाया राशि सूचना बरसा करने की तिथि

श्रीमती मित्रा कोरी श्री जीत सिंह 70190000001411 सखी बल और अचल संघति, जो खसरा संख्या 2443, क्षेत्रफल 50.16 वर्ग मीटर, परलना और तहसील- दाररी, बालाजी विहार, जिला-गौतम बुद्ध नगर, बु.पी., 201307. खानिब. मित्रा कोरी, और इसकी सीमाएं इस प्रकार हैं: में स्थित है और जो आवर्तित है: उत्तर: संजय यादव का प्लॉट, प्लॉट: 12 कुट चौड़ी सड़क, पश्चिम: किसी अन्य व्यक्ति का प्लॉट, दक्षिण: किसी अन्य व्यक्ति का प्लॉट

कवररी 18, 2026 अक्टूबर 03, 2026 रु.5,89,843.09 अप्रैल 10, 2026

आप से इस सूचना के माध्यम से यह मांग की जाती है की इस सूचना के प्रकाशन से 60 दिनों के भीतर आपके नाम के सामने वर्गीत बकाया लेन राशि ब्याज, खर्च, शुल्क सहित का भुगतान कर दें, अन्यथा सरकारी एक्ट की धारा 13 (4) के तहत अगली कार्यवाही की जाएगी। सुरक्षित संघति को वहीँम करने के लिए उपलब्ध समय के संबंध में कर्जदार का ध्यान, अधिनियम की धारा 13 की उपधारा (8) के प्राधान्यों की और आमंत्रित किया जाता है।

स्थान: गौतम बुद्ध नगर तारीख: अप्रैल 21, 2026 प्राधिकृत अधिकारी बंधन बैंक सिमिडिड

PANIC, SCREAMS & RESCUE

Udhampur bus crash: Survivors recall chaos, hail Army's heroic act

MPOST BUREAU

RAMNAGAR (J&K): Survivors of the deadly Udhampur bus tragedy recalled scenes of sheer panic and desperate cries for help, crediting the Army's swift and heroic rescue with saving numerous lives.

At least 21 people were killed and 29 others injured on Monday when a packed private passenger bus plunged nearly 100 metres down a treacherous hillside in Jammu and Kashmir's Udhampur, crushing an auto-rickshaw before landing horrifically upside down on the road below.

An Army convoy passing along the winding hilly stretch rushed to the spot and led the intense rescue operation after the driver of the private bus lost control while negotiating a sharp blind curve near the hilltop Kagort village in the Ramnagar area around 10 am.

Amid piercing screams, mangled metal and entangled bodies, hope seemed to fade with each passing moment, survivors said, recalling the harrowing accident on the Udhampur-Ramnagar road, about 40 km from the district headquarters.

"Army personnel were the first to reach us, appearing like messiahs amid the chaos and confusion. They pulled us out of the wreckage. I had a miraculous escape — this feels nothing less than a second life for me," said Neetu Rani (32), wife of Sanjay Sharma, said from her hospital bed.

Still shaken, she recalled the terrifying moments after the crash, saying there were cries for help all around as injured passengers lay trapped inside the mangled bus before rescuers arrived swiftly and began evacuating them.

Having sustained injuries to



Wrecked remains of a passenger bus after it rolled down a hill, in Udhampur district, on Monday

INSIGHT

» At least 21 people were killed when a private passenger bus plunged nearly 100 metres down a treacherous hillside

» An Army convoy passing along the hilly stretch rushed to the spot and led the intense rescue operation

her back, legs and face, she said she was on her way to her maternal home in Udhampur when the accident occurred. Rani said the journey, meant to be a routine visit to her mother's house, turned into a nightmare within moments as the bus lost control on the treacherous stretch.

An Army soldier, who was leading a convoy from Udhampur to Ramnagar, said they swung into action immediately after noticing the civilian vehicle rolling down the hill. "I was leading the convoy when the accident occurred on the way. The vehicle fell from a height of nearly 100 metres. We immediately secured the area and launched the rescue operation, thus saving many

precious lives including those of men and women with great difficulty," the soldier said.

Army personnel were soon joined by local villagers and police teams led by Deputy Inspector General of Police, Udhampur-Reasi Range, Shiv Kumar Sharma, who worked in close coordination to break open the mangled remains of the bus and extricate the injured on priority.

The rescuers pulled out survivors trapped in the wreckage before carefully retrieving the bodies of the deceased.

Sahil Thappa's uncle Rajesh said they are thankful to the rescuers including the Army and the police for their prompt action. Thappa (19) was among nearly a dozen students heading for college on board the bus and had suffered head injuries in the accident.

During its violent descent, the bus struck an auto-rickshaw on the road below before crashing with massive force and landing upside down. The impact was so severe that the entire top portion of the bus was crushed, leaving the vehicle mangled and trapping several passengers inside the wreckage.

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

JODHPUR: A massive fire broke out on Monday afternoon at the HPCL Rajasthan Refinery Limited (HRRL) in Barmer, a day ahead of its scheduled inauguration by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas later confirmed the incident, following which the April 21 dedication ceremony was postponed.

Terming the incident "unfortunate", the ministry said the fire broke out at the crude distillation unit. It added in a statement that a revised date for the inauguration will be announced later.

The ministry further said the blaze has since been brought under control and that no casualties have been reported. However, an investigation has been ordered to determine the cause of the blaze and recommend remedial measures. The project, by Hindustan Petroleum Corpo-

WAS SLATED TO BE INAUGURATED BY PM TODAY

Fire at Rajasthan refinery puts launch on hold



Firefighters douse a blaze after a fire broke out at the HPCL Pachpadra Refinery, in Balotra, Rajasthan, Monday

ration Limited, represents one of the most important energy and industrial developments in the country. The refinery, commonly called the Pachpadra refinery, has the potential to produce 9 million tonnes of petroleum annually, and this will be a complete refin-

ery-petrochemical complex. The refinery will manufacture BS-VI grade petroleum products such as petrol and diesel, as well as petrochemicals used in the plastic industry.

With a cost of investment exceeding Rs. 70,000 crore, this would be one of the biggest

projects in Rajasthan and will have a huge potential to make the arid region of Barmer one of the industrial giants of India.

Further, the relevance of the project is enhanced by the current political instability in West Asia, a strategically important region in terms of global oil

supplies. Any disruption to shipping lanes or instability in the crude oil market, which was evidenced recently in the Strait of Hormuz, highlights the importance of establishing local refining facilities.

Against this context, the Barmer Refinery helps in securing energy resources for the northwestern regions of the country. Thus, the project adds to the energy security of India, to an extent, by providing a more consistent fuel supply. Furthermore, it supports the ongoing trend of self-reliance of the country in various key industries, in light of high demand for petrochemical products in India.

As far as the company HPCL is concerned, the project will enhance its overall refining capacity and help the company stand out amongst other top players in India's oil sector. Nationally, the project is expected to serve as a hub for the petrochemical and industrial complex in western India.

'Punjab to have horticulture learning centre'

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH: Punjab will have a dedicated horticulture experience and learning centre on the lines the World Horti Center ecosystem, officials said on Monday.

As a part of his visit for investment promotion outreach in the Netherlands on Monday, the Chief Minister undertook key visits to leading horticulture institutions, including the World Horti Center (WHC), Westland, and the globally renowned Keukenhof, Lisse, to study best practices in sustainable agriculture, floriculture, and high-efficiency farming systems, said an official statement here.

He mooted the idea of establishing such a centre in Punjab and said that the proposed centre would bring together researchers, academic institutions, industry partners, and



CM Mann on Monday visited leading horticulture institutions in the Netherlands, including the WHC, Westland

government stakeholders to promote innovation, skill development, and the adoption of sustainable agricultural solutions in the state.

At the World Horti Center, a global hub for greenhouse horticulture innovation, Mann was received by CEO Puck van Holsteijn and Manager International Business Lenny Dijkshoorn, who led a comprehensive tour of the facility.

Mann said it was a unique

experience as they were introduced to the Netherlands' globally acclaimed ecosystem of greenhouse and controlled-environment agriculture, where the integration of technology, research, education, industry, and government has transformed traditional farming into a high-productivity and sustainable sector. He said the key learnings included the effectiveness of greenhouse and advanced indoor farming systems, which

significantly enhance crop yields while ensuring efficient water usage, reduced reliance on pesticides, and improved farmer incomes compared to conventional open-field farming.

Mann said this can be helpful for the state to give a major push to crop diversification and bring the farmers out of the vicious circle of water-guzzling crops.

The Chief Minister said that the role of automation, robotics, artificial intelligence, and precision irrigation systems in optimizing plant growth and resource efficiency, along with innovative water management practices such as rainwater harvesting, reuse of irrigation water, and controlled nutrient delivery systems to ensure climate-resilient agricultural production is also a new learning.

He said both sides explored avenues for collaboration and, in principle, agreed to it.

Allahabad HC judge recuses from Rahul Gandhi dual citizenship case

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: Proceedings in the dual citizenship case involving Congress leader Rahul Gandhi took a dramatic turn on Monday after Justice Subhash Vidyarthi of the Lucknow bench of the Allahabad High Court recused himself from hearing the matter, citing concerns over the petitioner's conduct.

At the outset of the hearing, Justice Vidyarthi referred to certain social media posts made by petitioner Vignesh Shishir, stating that they contained threatening language and remarks against the judiciary. Questioning the petitioner's conduct, the judge asked how allegations against the court could be made publicly without justification.

He also observed that the petitioner appeared to have used the judicial process for political purposes and said he had been subjected to harassment and injustice.

When the petitioner attempted to respond, the court declined to hear him further and directed that the case file be placed before the Chief Justice for the constitution of a fresh bench.

The petitioner, a BJP worker from Karnataka, has alleged that Rahul Gandhi holds dual citizenship and participated in electoral processes in the United Kingdom, claiming to possess supporting documents.

The case has seen rapid developments in recent days.

On April 17, the court had directed registration of an FIR and a CBI probe. However, a day later, Justice Vidyarthi reversed the order, noting that established legal procedure required issuing notice to the concerned party before any such direction.

Controversy escalated after the petitioner posted messages on social media platform X warning of exposing alleged links involving mafia and illegal networks, and making references to bribery, though without naming individuals.

The matter, originally filed in a Raebareilly MP-MLA court and later transferred to Lucknow, had been dismissed earlier this year, prompting the High Court petition.

Puducherry L-G commends Sikhs' role in nation-building



MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH/PUDUCHERRY: Puducherry Lieutenant Governor K. Kailashnathan joined the Sikh Sangat at Gurdwara Sri Guru Nanak Dev Ji on Sunday to mark the twin occasions of Vaisakhi and Khalsa Sajna Divas, with a large gathering of devotees from Puducherry, Chennai and nearby regions creating an atmosphere of spiritual fervour and communal harmony.

Addressing the congregation, Kailashnathan highlighted the Sikh community's immense contribution to the nation, praising its legacy of sacrifice, service and commitment to national progress. He underlined the enduring relevance of core Sikh values such as seva (selfless service) and langar (community kitchen), describing them as powerful symbols of equality and compassion that continue to inspire society.

The Gurudwara management accorded a warm welcome to the Lieutenant Governor and honoured him with traditional tokens, including a Tamil translation of Japji Sahib, sacred hymns of Guru Tegh Bahadur, and a model of Sri Darbar Sahib. He was also presented with a shirapao, a robe of honour symbolising respect in Sikh tradition.

'ABHAY': CBI unveils AI chatbot to fight digital arrest scams

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: Amid a surge in digital fraud, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has introduced an artificial intelligence-powered system, 'Abhay', aimed at helping citizens verify suspicious messages and avoid online scams. The tool enables users to check the authenticity of communications purportedly sent by the agency, offering a reliable alternative to guesswork in an era of rapidly spreading fake alerts.

The system was unveiled by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant at the 22nd D.P. Kohli Memorial Lecture, an annual event hosted by the CBI in honour of its founding director. Speaking on "Challenges of Cyber Crime: Role for Police and Judiciary," the CJI highlighted the growing sophistication of cyber threats and the need for evolving countermeasures.

The launch comes against the backdrop of increasing "digital arrest" scams, where fraudsters impersonate officials from agencies like the CBI. Vic-

CLOSER LOOK

» The tool enables users to check the authenticity of communications purportedly sent by the agency

» The system was unveiled by CJI Surya Kant

tims are often shown forged documents and subjected to prolonged video calls designed to create fear and compliance, ultimately forcing them to transfer large sums of money.

According to the agency, 'Abhay' allows quick verification of such claims, helping users identify fraudulent communications before taking any action. This assumes greater significance as fake government messages are increasingly used to coerce payments.

The Supreme Court has recently noted that nearly Rs 40,000 crore has been lost to digital fraud, underlining the scale of the threat.

The event also saw 24 officers being honoured for meritorious service.

NFR logs record track upgrades

MALIGAON: The Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) recorded notable progress in track modernisation, maintenance and safety during 2025-26, setting new internal benchmarks and boosting efficiency.

A key highlight was the expanded use of Phased Array Ultrasonic Testing, with 53,544 welds inspected to enhance track reliability. NFR achieved a record 457 Complete Track Renewal units, while rail and sleeper renewals reached 449.42 km and 465.02 km respectively.

Track stability improved with 9.57 lakh cubic metres of ballast. Track fittings renewal exceeded targets, and 4,312 points were tamped.

MPOST

CBI arrests two senior RCOM officials in bank 'fraud' case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The CBI on Monday said it has arrested two senior executives of Reliance Communications (RCOM), a company of the Anil Ambani group, in an alleged bank fraud case, the agency said on Monday.

It identified the officials as RCOM vice president Anil Kalya and joint president D Vishwanath. The federal agency will seek their remand before a court.

The investigation pertains to RCOM, Anil Ambani and others, registered based on a complaint filed by the State Bank of India (SBI), with allegations that the bank sanctioned credit facilities to the company but due to

The arrested officials include RCOM vice president Anil Kalya and joint president D Vishwanath

the accused borrowers "fraudulent" activities, the lender suffered a wrongful loss of around Rs 2,929.05 crore.

According to the complaint, a wrongful loss of Rs 19,694 crore was caused to 17 public sector banks and financial institutions. Investigation found that RCOM entered into "circuitous" transactions through "shell" entities controlled by company officials. Furthermore, the CBI

said in a statement that RCOM obtained discounted Letters of Credit (LCs) opened for "bogus" service-related transactions with its group entities, which devolved and caused huge losses to the banks.

According to the agency, Vishwanath was in overall charge of the group's banking operations, and he directed the "misutilisation" of funds.

It said he coordinated with banks for the sanction and disbursement of the facilities to the accused company. The probe agency said Kalya "actively" supported Vishwanath, adding that they were both "important" RCOM functionaries managing corporate finance, banking operations, payments and fund utilisation.

CIVIL SERVICES DAY 2026

Tech, transparency, efficiency: CS Jain's governance reset in MP

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: As the nation observes Civil Services Day today (April 21), Madhya Pradesh's Chief Secretary Anurag Jain, a 1989-batch IAS officer, emerges as a standout example of dynamic and result-oriented administration. Since assuming charge on October 3, 2024, Jain has infused fresh energy into state governance by emphasising speed, inter-departmental coordination, technology integration, and citizen-centric service delivery. His immediate focus areas include strengthening bureaucratic efficiency, accelerating the implementation of welfare schemes, and fostering tighter collaboration between the state and central governments. Within a short span, he rolled out upgrades in grievance redressal mechanisms, introduced the e-office system across departments to minimise delays and enhance transparency, and promoted the MPeSeva App to make services more accessible and responsive.

Jain's extensive national experience adds depth to his

HIGHLIGHTS

- » **Tech-driven governance:** e-office, AI, and citizen-centric services
- » **Investment push:** New policies and summit-driven inflows
- » **Infra boost:** State Highways and greenfield corridors
- » **Social & education reforms:** Improved access and outcomes
- » **Simhastha prep:** Large-scale infrastructure and event planning



initiatives in Madhya Pradesh. An IIT Kharagpur graduate with a MicroMasters from MIT, he played a key role in launching the Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana and shaping the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan. He is a recipient of the Prime Minister's Award for Excellence in Public Administration, along with the Web Ratna and National e-Governance Awards.

In Madhya Pradesh, these insights are yielding tangible results. Jain steered the successful Global Investors Summit 2025 in Bhopal, attracting major investment proposals now being fast-tracked. He

is also personally monitoring four mission-mode programmes focused on the poor, youth, women, and farmers.

A key highlight of his tenure is the rollout of new investment policies to improve ease of doing business and attract domestic and global investors. With a focus on emerging sectors like semiconductors, drones, animation, gaming, and extended reality, the reforms include single-window clearances, simplified compliance, and investor facilitation, making Madhya Pradesh more competitive and investor-friendly.

Complementing these

measures is a strong push on infrastructure, with Jain overseeing highways and greenfield corridors to boost connectivity, industry, and religious tourism. Key MPRDC projects, including the Indore-Ujjain Greenfield Corridor and Ujjain-Jaora Expressway, aim to cut logistics costs, improve safety, and spur new industrial hubs, especially ahead of Simhastha 2028.

Preparations for Simhastha 2028 are in full swing under Jain, who has approved nearly 40 key infrastructure projects, including road safety audits, urban upgrades, and a Narmada conservation drive. The

focus is on timely completion of water, sanitation, traffic, and digital systems to ensure seamless management and position the event as a model of large-scale organisation while preserving its spiritual and ecological heritage.

On the social front, Jain has pushed school education reforms to curb drop-outs and improve outcomes. Timely distribution of textbooks, bicycles, scooters, and laptops—especially for girls and marginalised students—along with early declaration of results, is aiding smooth academic transitions and improving retention rates.

Jain has positioned artificial intelligence as a key pillar of future-ready governance, emphasising its role in improving service delivery, enhancing productivity, and contributing to Viksit Bharat 2047. The state is advancing Centres of Excellence, real-time data analytics, and reliable 24x7 power to support this vision.

In a bid to strengthen financial governance, the state plans to establish a Financial Training and Research Institute. The idea, considered to

have been brought by the Chief Secretary, reflects his financial expertise. The institute aims to enhance accountability, improve financial discipline, and curb irregularities in government spending.

At a time when civil servants are expected to deliver more with greater efficiency, Anurag Jain presents a practical model: combine technical expertise with administrative discipline, back bold reforms with data and technology, and maintain an unwavering focus on outcomes that touch citizens' lives.

His one-year extension as Chief Secretary — a rare recognition — reflects the confidence reposed in his leadership by both the state and central governments.

On Civil Services Day, Anurag Jain's initiatives in Madhya Pradesh—spanning investment, infrastructure, education, e-governance, and Simhastha 2028 preparations—offer lessons in innovative, accountable governance, demonstrating how committed leadership can transform administration and advance the vision of a developed India.



EDITORIAL
WORKERS
AND
WELFARE

Uttar Pradesh's latest minimum wage revision, effective from April 1, 2026, is not just a routine administrative update—it is a response to a deeper churn in the state's labour landscape. Triggered in part by unrest in industrial clusters such as Noida and Greater Noida, the revision increases wages across categories—unskilled, semi-skilled and skilled—by roughly 15 to 20 per cent. On paper, that is a meaningful rise. For a state positioning itself as an industrial hub, particularly along the NCR belt, the move signals an attempt to balance growth ambitions with worker welfare. But beyond the headline figures lies a more complex question: does this revision meaningfully improve the lives of workers, or does it merely catch up with rising costs that have already outpaced incomes?

To understand the significance of the revision, one must situate it within the realities of urban and semi-urban Uttar Pradesh. Industrial districts such as Gautam Buddh Nagar, Ghaziabad and parts of Lucknow have seen rapid expansion, drawing in migrant labour from across the state and neighbouring regions. These workers operate at the margins of formal employment, often with limited job security and rising living expenses—rent, transport, food and healthcare. Over the past few years, inflationary pressures have eroded real wages, even as nominal wages remained stagnant or increased only marginally through periodic adjustments in the variable dearness allowance. The protests that preceded the revision were not sudden disruptions; they were the culmination of a sustained squeeze on household incomes. In that sense, the wage hike is less a proactive reform and more a necessary correction.

Yet, the structural limitations of India's minimum wage system remain unchanged. Wages continue to be segmented across skill levels, sectors and regions, creating a patchwork rather than a uniform safety net. A worker in an NCR-adjacent district faces a cost of living vastly different from one in a rural hinterland, yet statutory wages do not always reflect this disparity adequately. Moreover, minimum wages are, by definition, subsistence wages—they are designed to prevent exploitation, not to ensure economic mobility. Even after the revision, many workers will find that their earnings barely cover basic expenses, leaving little room for savings, education or upward movement. The informal sector, which employs a substantial share of the workforce, further complicates the picture. Enforcement of minimum wage laws in such settings is uneven, and compliance often depends on local administrative capacity and employer willingness.

For industry, the implications are mixed but manageable. Labour-intensive sectors—manufacturing, construction, small and medium enterprises—will face higher wage bills in the short term. This could lead to concerns about cost competitiveness, particularly in a state competing with others for investment. However, the relationship between wages and productivity is not adversarial by default. Better-paid workers are often more stable, less prone to attrition, and potentially more productive. The larger challenge for industry lies not in the wage increase itself, but in the predictability of policy. When revisions are perceived as reactive—driven by protests rather than periodic, transparent mechanisms—it creates uncertainty for businesses planning long-term investments. A structured, formula-driven approach to wage revisions would serve both labour and industry better than episodic adjustments.

Ultimately, what the revision changes most is the signal it sends. It acknowledges that growth cannot be sustained without addressing the concerns of those who power it. It reflects a recognition that labour unrest is not merely a law-and-order issue, but a symptom of deeper economic imbalances. However, the revision also underscores the limits of incrementalism. Without complementary reforms—stronger enforcement, greater formalisation of jobs, investment in skill development, and a clearer linkage between wages and living costs—the impact of such hikes will remain constrained. Uttar Pradesh's aspiration to become a major economic engine hinges not just on attracting investment, but on ensuring that growth translates into tangible improvements in livelihoods. The current wage revision is a step in that direction, but it is only a beginning. The real test will lie in whether it leads to a more predictable, equitable and sustainable wage framework—one that moves beyond crisis-driven adjustments to a more durable vision of labour welfare.

PUBLIC
SERVICE



ALOK RANJAN

THE WRITER IS A FORMER IAS OFFICER WHO SERVED AS THE CHIEF SECRETARY, GOVT OF UTTAR PRADESH

India must look beyond symbolism and ask whether its administrative machinery is prepared for the demands of a fast-changing democracy

STRATEGIC
FLUX



PRABHU DAYAL

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED INDIAN DIPLOMAT AND HAD PREVIOUSLY SERVED AS CONSUL GENERAL IN NEW YORK

The Iran conflict has shaken energy routes, exposed strategic dependencies and forced countries from India to Japan, Europe, China and the Gulf to rethink security, trade and survival

Bureaucracy for a New India

On this Civil Services Day, the moment is not just to honour India's bureaucracy, but to reform and prepare it for a changing nation

Every year on April 21, India marks Civil Services Day, a moment to recognise the quiet, enduring contribution of those who keep the machinery of governance running across the vast expanse of the country. It is not merely a ceremonial occasion; it is an opportunity to reflect on the past, assess the present, and reimagine the future of India's civil services.

The date carries deep historical significance. On this day in 1947, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel addressed the first batch of civil servants of independent India at Metcalfe House in Delhi. In that seminal address, he described the civil services as the "steel frame of India"—a phrase that has since become central to our understanding of the role of the bureaucracy in a democratic polity. Patel's vision was clear: a civil service that is politically neutral, administratively competent, and courageous enough to speak truth to power.

India inherited a bureaucratic system designed primarily to serve colonial interests. The Indian Civil Service (ICS) was efficient but distant from the people it governed. After Independence, the challenge was not merely to retain administrative continuity but to transform the ethos of governance itself.

Over the decades, the civil services, particularly the Indian Administrative Service (IAS), Indian Police Service (IPS), and other allied services, have evolved into institutions that underpin India's democratic framework. They played a critical role in integrating princely states, conducting free and fair elections, maintaining law and order, and implementing policies aimed at socio-economic transformation.

From managing food shortages in the early years to steering economic reforms in the 1990s, civil servants have been at the heart of India's journey. They have provided continuity in governance even as political leadership has changed, thereby ensuring stability in a diverse and often complex society.

In today's India, the role of civil services has expanded both in scope and complexity.

At the most fundamental level, civil servants are responsible for delivering public services to citizens. Whether it is ensuring that welfare schemes reach the intended beneficiaries



Civil servants are the link between policy and implementation, between vision and reality

through Direct Benefit Transfers or enabling access to healthcare, education, and food security, the effectiveness of governance is ultimately judged by outcomes on the ground.

In the domain of law and order, the police and administrative machinery play a crucial role in maintaining internal stability. Conducting elections in a country as large and diverse as India is itself a monumental administrative exercise, one that has earned global recognition.

Civil servants are also key drivers of development. From building infrastructure to implementing flagship programmes like the Aspirational Districts Programme, they translate policy into action. Their role as district administrators—often working in challenging conditions—remains one of the most visible and impactful aspects of governance.

Perhaps most striking is their role in times of crisis. The COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated the importance of an agile and committed administrative apparatus. From managing health systems to coordinating relief efforts, civil servants were at the forefront. Similarly, during natural disasters—floods, cyclones, earthquakes—they act as first responders, often working around the clock to save lives and restore normalcy.

Yet, the context in which civil services operate is undergoing rapid transformation. The challenges of the 21st century are fundamentally different from those of the past.

Technological disruption is reshaping governance. Artificial intelligence, big data, and digital platforms are creating new oppor-

tunities—but also raising complex questions around privacy, ethics, and regulation. Climate change is emerging as a defining challenge, requiring coordinated policy responses across sectors and geographies. Rapid urbanisation is straining infrastructure and governance capacities, while rural areas continue to demand inclusive growth.

At the same time, citizens today are more aware, more connected, and more demanding. They expect transparency, accountability, and responsiveness from public institutions. Social media has amplified both scrutiny and expectations.

Within this evolving landscape, civil servants often have to navigate competing pressures—balancing political directives with administrative neutrality, managing limited resources, and responding to public demands in real time.

If the civil services are to remain relevant and effective, reform is not optional—it is essential. The objective must not be to dismantle the existing system, but to strengthen and modernise it while preserving its core values.

One of the most important areas is domain specialisation. The traditional generalist model, while valuable in providing administrative flexibility, needs to be complemented by deep expertise in sectors such as healthcare, infrastructure, digital economy, and environmental policy. Complex problems require specialised knowledge.

Capacity building and continuous learning must become integral to a civil servant's career. Training can no longer be con-

finied to the early years; it must be an ongoing process. Familiarity with emerging technologies, particularly AI and data analytics, will be critical for effective decision-making.

A balanced approach to lateral entry can also enrich the system by bringing in external expertise, while ensuring that the institutional integrity and ethos of the civil services are preserved.

Equally important is the need for performance management reforms. Evaluation systems must move beyond seniority and focus on measurable outcomes and impact. Recognising and rewarding excellence can create a culture of accountability and innovation.

At the same time, ethical reinforcement is crucial. Honest and upright officers must feel protected and supported. Mechanisms that encourage integrity and discourage corruption are fundamental to public trust.

The integration of technology in governance offers immense potential. From predictive analytics in policing to real-time monitoring of schemes, digital tools can enhance efficiency and transparency. However, technology must remain a means to an end, not a substitute for human judgment and empathy.

Finally, there is a strong case for greater decentralisation. Empowering local governments and district administrations can make governance more responsive and context-specific. Decision-making closer to the ground often leads to better outcomes.

At its core, governance is about people. The future of civil services must therefore be anchored in a

citizen-centric approach.

This means not just delivering services efficiently, but doing so with empathy and respect. It requires effective communication, active engagement with communities, and a willingness to listen. Feedback mechanisms and participatory governance can strengthen the relationship between the state and its citizens.

Civil servants must increasingly see themselves not merely as administrators, but as facilitators of change, partners in the collective journey towards national development.

India has set for itself an ambitious goal: to become a developed nation by 2047, marking 100 years of Independence. Achieving this vision—often articulated as "Viksit Bharat"—will require sustained economic growth, social inclusion, technological advancement, and environmental sustainability.

Civil services will play a central role in this transformation. They are the link between policy and implementation, between vision and reality. Their ability to design effective programmes, execute them efficiently, and adapt to changing circumstances will determine the pace and quality of India's progress.

No country has achieved developed status without a capable, professional, and forward-looking civil service. India will be no exception.

As we celebrate Civil Services Day, it is important to return to the ideals articulated by Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel. Integrity, courage, impartiality, and a deep commitment to public service remain as relevant today as they were in 1947.

But the times demand more. The "steel frame" must evolve into a system that is not only strong, but also agile, innovative, and humane. It must embrace change without losing its core values.

The future of India will be shaped not only by its political leadership or economic policies, but also by the everyday actions of its civil servants—often taken far from the spotlight, yet profoundly impactful.

On this Civil Services Day, the nation salutes these silent nation-builders. And as India marches towards its aspirations of becoming a developed country, the call is clear: to renew, strengthen, and reimagine the steel frame for the challenges of tomorrow.

Views expressed are personal

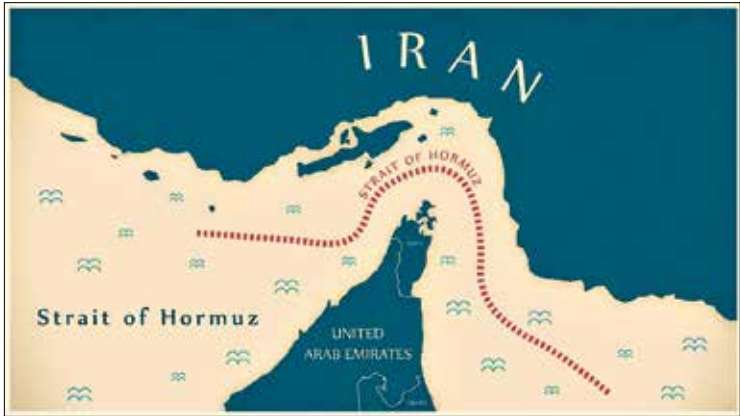
Global Price of a War

What began as a direct military confrontation with Iran has triggered a wider geopolitical and economic reckoning across continents, markets and alliances

The 2026 US and Israel war against Iran has fundamentally ruptured the existing political order, transitioning the Middle East from a "shadow war" into a direct, volatile regional conflagration. The Iranian retaliation, resulting in the de facto closure of the Strait of Hormuz, has inflicted a severe energy shock, driving oil prices above \$100 per barrel and causing systemic disruptions to global supply chains. Consequently, this war is not merely a localised event but a catalyst for a volatile new landscape impacting different global players.

The war has brutally shattered the security illusion of the Gulf Cooperation Council, dismantling the long-held perception that these nations were insulated safe havens focused on economic development. Iran's widespread retaliation, targeting vital energy infrastructure, ports, and airports across all six GCC members, resulted in the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and brought the regional war to their doorsteps, exposing the limitations of relying on the United States for security while proving that local detente efforts with Tehran were ineffective. Consequently, the Gulf states have been forced into a reassessment of their foreign policies to face an increasingly hostile and unpredictable Iran.

The conflict has introduced severe economic and strategic pressures on India, primarily driven by its heavy reliance on the Middle East for energy. With the disruption of the Strait of Hormuz, through which a significant portion of India's crude oil and nearly 90 per cent of its Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG) passes, energy security has been compromised, causing a surge in LPG prices, domestic fuel price hikes, and potential supply shortages for industries. Indian maritime security is also on high alert, with the navy on standby to protect shipping lanes.



The ongoing conflict has exposed how fragile the architecture of global energy and security remains

The conflict has created significant instability for the estimated 9-10 million Indian diaspora members residing in the Arab Gulf countries (GCC), transforming from a distant geopolitical event into a direct, daily risk for many. As Iranian drones and missiles have targeted areas near U.S. military bases and critical infrastructure in countries like the UAE, Saudi Arabia, and Qatar, Indian workers—a vast majority in construction, retail, and hospitality—have faced panic, disrupted daily commutes, and temporary shutdowns of work sites. If the situation escalates, it threatens not only the safety of the workers but also the steady inflow of remittances—crucial to the Indian economy—due to potential job losses in the stalled economic sectors.

The war in Iran is placing a significant strain on NATO, eroding internal trust and exposing a deep divide between U.S. and European strategic priorities. As Washington leads a high-stakes campaign against Tehran, often without prior consultation with allies, many European members are focusing on the security of their own continent—particularly the ongoing conflict in Ukraine—

leading to a "two-track" NATO where Europe offers only minimal support for U.S. actions. This divergence has fueled tensions, with US leadership criticising NATO allies as "cowards" or "paper tigers" for resisting involvement, and even threatening to reconsider the value of the alliance.

For Russia, the war has emerged as a significant geopolitical and economic boon, primarily by alleviating the economic strain caused by its ongoing invasion of Ukraine and distracting Western allies. As the conflict disrupted energy supplies in the Persian Gulf, oil prices surged, allowing Russia to fill the supply gap, boost its export revenues, and secure a potential windfall of tens of billions of dollars. Furthermore, the conflict has forced the United States to prioritise the Middle East, reducing the immediacy of Western diplomatic pressure on Moscow and, crucially, diverting military resources and air defence ammunition that could otherwise have been supplied to Ukraine.

As regards China, the Iran war has created significant, multifaceted challenges, forcing Beijing to balance its reli-

ance on Iranian oil with the need for global economic stability. As the world's largest oil importer, China faces immediate threats from surging energy prices and disruptions to shipping routes, specifically in the Strait of Hormuz, where a substantial portion of its oil and LNG passes. Geopolitically, the conflict has weakened China's "strategic partnership" with Iran, which saw its Iranian oil ecosystem disrupted, while creating a dilemma for Beijing in supporting a key ally without triggering direct conflict with the United States.

The ongoing conflict involving Iran is heavily impacting Japan, primarily by threatening its energy security and triggering inflationary pressures on its fragile economy. Because Japan depends on the Middle East for over 90 per cent of its crude oil imports—much of which passes through the volatile Strait of Hormuz—the effective blockade of this route has forced Tokyo to release 80 million barrels from its emergency reserves, its largest ever, to combat shortages. The spike in oil prices has raised fuel costs, worsened the business environment and triggered inflation on goods and shipping, forcing the Bank of Japan to reconsider hiking interest rates.

The above are some manifestations of how the Iran war has fundamentally dismantled the post-1979 regional order and is reshaping the global geopolitical landscape. The conflict has exposed deep vulnerabilities in maritime chokepoints like the Strait of Hormuz, accelerating a geoeconomic shift toward supply chain diversification and a global surge in energy costs. Arab nations are forced into a "security paradox" of choosing between long-term economic reforms and immediate survival. Ultimately, the war has demonstrated a breakdown of international norms, thereby accelerating the transition toward a chaotic global order.

Views expressed are personal

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Surkhasha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Salim @ Rahul** s/o Rahish R/o Vegabond Ring Road, near Viyps Collage, Rani Bagh Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR. No. 637/24 u/s 309(4)/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita**. Has been registered at **P.S. K.N.K Marg Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said, **Salim @ Rahul** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Salim @ Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Salim @ Rahul** of under **FIR. No. 637/24 u/s 309(4)/317(2) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita**. Registered at: **P.S.K.N.K.Marg, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026**

By Order
DP/4798/RD/2026
(court matter)

Sh. Himanshu Sehloth, Ld.
JMFC-03, Room No.213,
Rohini Court Delhi

**कार्यालय, कार्यपालक अभियंता,
लघु सिंचाई प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज
शुद्धि-पत्र**

इस कार्यालय के द्वारा प्रकाशित अल्पकालीन पुनः ई-निविदा संख्या- WRD/MID/SAHIBGANI/F-2-01/20 26-27 एवं पी० आर० नं०- 376465 Minor Irrigation (26 -27)#D के Date of Publication of E-Tender on web site की तिथि- 09.04.2026 के स्थान पर दिनांक- 21.04. 2026 एवं Last date/ Time for Submission of E-Tender BID's की तिथि- 20.04.2026 के स्थान पर दिनांक- 29.04. 2026 एवं Date of Opening Tender की तिथि-21.04.2026 के स्थान पर दिनांक- 30.04.2026 पढ़ा जाय। निविदा की बाकी सभी शर्तें यथावत रहेंगी।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
लघु सिंचाई प्रमंडल, साहेबगंज।
PR.NO.377939 Minor Irrigation(26-27):D

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Sameer Rana @ Chinu** S/o Mahender Singh Rana R/o Kh. No. 1108/7, Samadhi Mandir Road, Rithala, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case FIR No. 738/2022 u/s 392/411/34 IPC at P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Sameer Rana @ Chinu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sameer Rana @ Chinu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sameer Rana @ Chinu** accused of FIR No. 738/2022 u/s 392/411/34 IPC at P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on 30.05.2026.

By Order: Ms. Shagun,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06, (North-West)
Room No. 109, 1st Floor,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/4891/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajpal S/o Lt. Shri Ram Kumar R/o Village+Post Khara, Dabar, New Delhi-110073** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 528693/2016 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Rajpal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajpal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rajpal** of **CC No. 528693/2016 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Subzi Mandi, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Urvi Gupta
Judicial Magistrate First Class (NI Act)-01
Room No. 201, CBA-II
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5166/N/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.PC/ 84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Sunil Dutt Sharma R/o 1/4414, Second Floor, Main Mandoli Road, Shahdara, Delhi** has committed (or are suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No./CC No. **1408/18 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Gokal Puri, Distt. North-East, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Sunil Dutt Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Sunil Dutt Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Sunil Dutt Sharma** of **FIR No./CC No. 1408/18 U/s 138 NI Act, PS Gokal Puri, Distt. North-East, Delhi** required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **01.06.2026 at 10:00 AM**.

By Order
Sh. Pankaj Rai
Judicial Magistrate-First Class-01
Court No. 73, Distt. North-East
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/3628/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil, S/o.: Subhash, R/o.: GF, FF Premises Opp. To H. No.: 131A, Balmiki Mohalla, Ranholla Extn., New Delhi-110041** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **Ct. Cases No.1016/2024 U/S 135 Electricity Act** registered at **P.S Ranhola, Outer District, Delhi** and it has been returned on a warrant of arrest thereupon issued stating that the said **Sunil** could not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Sunil** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Sunil**, accused of **Ct. Cases No.1016/2024 U/S 135 Electricity Act, P.S Ranhola, Outer District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.05.2026**.

By Order, **Rakesh Kumar-IV Electricity Act, Special Court, Additional Sessions Judge (Electricity)-01 (Central) Court No.409, Extension Block, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi**

DP/5106/OD/2026
(Court Matter)

Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd.

NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SECURITIZATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002

The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd., a Non Banking Financial Company (duly registered with Reserve Bank of India) under the provision of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) (hereinafter referred to as "SARFAESI Act, 2002") having its Registered Office: W2/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008 (hereinafter referred to as "CLIX"), and is engaged in the business of providing financial assistance to meet the needs of over millions of its customers all over India, hereby issues to you the following notice :-

Name & Address Of Borrower/Co-Borrower : 1. M/s. BMR DIAGNOSTICS CENTRE LIMITED, ZB-33/487, PN 4 & 5 DILSHAD GARDEN INDUSTRIAL AREA, SHAHDARA NEAR GT ROAD DELHI EAST DELHI 110095, 2. MR. SACHIN KUMAR GOEL S/O PURSHOTTAM DAS GOEL, 3. MR. NAVEEN KUMAR GOEL S/O PURSHOTTAM DAS GOEL, 4. MR. PURSHOTTAM DAS S/O REDTI SARAN, ALL AT - HOUSE NO. 110, AYODHYA GANJ, DADRI, GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, UTTAR PRADESH 203207, ALSO AT - ZB-33/487, PN 4 & 5 DILSHAD GARDEN INDUSTRIAL AREA, SHAHDARA NEAR GT ROAD DELHI EAST DELHI 110095

Loan A/c Number : 0007089389001001, Loan Amount Availed/Date: Rs. 4,57,60,934/- dated 30.12.2019, Date of 13(2) Notice : 15.04.2026, NPA Date - 02-Apr-2026, Demand Date and Amount as Per Sec. 13(2) Act, Notice : Rs. 1,18,55,581.35/- as on 13.04.2026

Mortgage Properties :

TYPE EQUIPMENT	NAME/DETAILS OF MANUFACTURER OF EQUIPMENT	INVOICE NO.	LOCATION WHERE EQUIPMENT IS USED/INSTALLED
EXPLORER PLUS BASE ELECTRONICS INDIA MRI SCANNER	WIPRO GE HEALTHCARE PVT. LTD. GO DHI. SUPPLY CHAIN INDIA PVT. LTD., DODDAHULLUR VILLAGE, KASABA HOBLI, HOSAKOTE TALUK BANGALORE, KA, 562114	KA/1920 /10804 88	BMR CENTRE LTD. CIVIL DIAGNOSTIC HOSPITAL, AMBALA CANTT AMBALA HARYANA HR IN 133001
IT 10KVA TRANSFORMER 3/3PH APPLE PC-IMAC ETSL RF SHIELDING 1.5T UPS EATON 93E 60KVA 4082V 65AN BATTERIES CABINET CABLES, COMMISSIONING AND 2 YEARS OF WARRANTY ON UPS AND SATTELITES	WIPRO GE HEALTHCARE PVT. LTD. CHAIN INDIA PVT. LTD., NEW SURVEY NO. 131, DODDAHULLUR VILLAGE, KASABA HOBLI, HOSAKOTE TALUK BANGALORE, KA, 562114	KA/1920 /10801 52	BMR CENTRE LTD. CIVIL DIAGNOSTIC HOSPITAL, AMBALA CANTT AMBALA HARYANA HR IN 133001
PHOTO PLETHYSMOGRAPH AND PATIENT CONFORT HOSE SIGNA CREATOR EXPLORER KIT-TJ EQUIPMENT ROOM KIT-TJ EXPLORER SOFTWARE IDENTIFIER 1888AT ENCFSR MINTING KIT SPT PHANTOM NO CART	WIPRO GE HEALTHCARE PVT. LTD. CIO DHI. SUPPLY CHAIN INDIA PVT LTD, INDO SPACE PWS INDUSTRIAL PARK PVT. LTD, VILL LUHARI, PATAUDI KULJANA ROAD, MDR 132-400B, POST LUHARI, TEHSIL & DISTT JHAJJAR, 124108	HR/1920 /000176 7	BMR DIAGNOSTIC CENTRE LTD. CIVIL HOSPITAL, AMBALA CANTT AMBALA HARYANA HR IN 133001

Further with reasons, we believe that you are evading the service of demand notice, hence this publication of demand notice. You are hereby called upon to pay Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd. with in a period of 60 days of date of publication of this demand notice the aforesaid amount along with further interest, cost, incidental expenses, charges etc., failing which Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd. will take necessary action under all or any of the provision of Sec. 13(4) of the said Act against all or any one or more of the secured assets including taking possession of this secured assets of the borrower(s). Further you are prohibited U/S 13(1B) of the said Act from transferring either by way of sale/lease or in any other way the aforesaid secured assets. Please note that no further demand notice will be issued.

Date - 21.04.2026, Place - UP Authorized officer, Clix Capital Services Pvt. Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.PC.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mukesh Juneja, S/o Shyam Sunder Juneja, R/o C-1/35-36, Sector-16, Rohini, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 341/2015, U/s 420/468/471 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mukesh Juneja** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mukesh Juneja** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mukesh Juneja** accused of **FIR No. 341/2015, U/s 420/468/471 IPC, P.S. Vijay Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **26.05.2026**.

By Order - Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class, North West
DP/5151/RD/2026 Room No. 109, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) (1) **Pawan S/o Mahendra** and (2) **Mahendra S/o Ram Sharan R/o H. No. B-2A, Main Gamri Road, In Front of Tikona Park, Gamri Extn. Bhajanpura, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case (1) **FIR No. 278/2019** and (2) **FIR No. 368/2022, U/s 135/150 IE Act, PS Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) **Pawan** and (2) **Mahendra** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) **Pawan** and (2) **Mahendra** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) (1) **Pawan** and (2) **Mahendra** of Case (1) **FIR No. 278/2019** and (2) **FIR No. 368/2022, U/s 135/150 IE Act, PS Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **20.05.2026**.

By Order
Ashish Rastogi
Additional Sessions Judge-05
Court No. 21, 1st Floor
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/4919/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

RAIL COACH FACTORY, KAPURTHALA

PCMM, RCF on behalf of President of India invites On-line bids for following items:-

Sr. No.	Tender No. & Due Date	Description	Qty. (Nos./Sets)	EMD (₹)
1.	02261118 08/05/2026	Harness of underframe and roof arrangement for LHB Power Car type Coaches	-	19,65,890/-
2.	05261210 13/05/2026	Under frame complete for LHB GS (EOG) Coaches.	51 Nos.	12,24,010/-
3.	05261225 08/05/2026	2 types of set of side wall & roof assembly for LHB Coaches PL No. 33559650 PL No. 33559661	74 Set 198 Set	20,00,000/-
4.	05261223 11/05/2026	Under frame complete for LHB SLR Coaches.	22 Nos.	5,45,160/-
5.	05261213 11/05/2026	Under frame complete for LHB SCN (EOG) Coaches.	45 Nos.	9,94,710/-
6.	05261015A 18/05/2026	Flat Roof Assly. for Vande Bharat TC type Coaches (PL No.33564310)	16 set	1,32,160/-
7.	14261026 07/05/2026	PVC Flooring Roll for Bangladesh Coaches	252 Nos.	1,94,830/-
8.	05261103 20/05/2026	Through Floor assembly complete for 3 Phase MEMU/DMC Coach (PL No. 37980786)	44 Nos.	2,47,140/-
9.	14261022 14/05/2026	PU Paints for LHB Coaches	508 Set	5,14,650/-
10.	17251401B 13/05/2026	(I) Set of Luggage Rack Modules for LHB Non AC Chair Car Coaches	82 Set	8,69,530/-
		(ii) Luggage Rack Modules (without Lights) for LHB 2nd AC Chair Car Coaches	18 Set	
11.	05261212 07/05/2026	End Part Complete	96 Nos.	4,37,260/-
12.	05261222 08/05/2026	Set of Front Part	26 set	1,75,240/-

1. For details and making On-line tenders, visit Website <http://ireps.gov.in>. Drawings/ specifications, wherever required can be downloaded from RCF Website <http://www.rcf.indianrailways.gov.in>. Class II/b digital signature certificate required for on-line bidding, can be obtained from licensed certifying agencies listed at <http://www.cce.gov.in>. 2. Tenders will close at 14.25 Hrs. on due date and will be opened at 14.30 Hrs. Tenders Sr. No.1 to 10 will be opened at RCF Kapurthala and Sr. No. 11 to 12 will be opened at Tilak Bridge, New Delhi. 3. For queries, contact IREPS Helpdesk at 011-24102855, 011-24105180 or RCF helpdesk at 011-23378658. **Note:** GST Number of RCF is 03AAAGM0289C1ZT. All the suppliers are advised to quote this in dispatch documents for the supplies made by them.

CORRIGENDUM

The following amendment is authorized against (1) **Tender No. 17261004** and **17261006** due on 17.04.2026 regarding due date to be read as 24.04.2026 instead of 17.04.2026. Condition added as Annexure 'D' in tender document and Eligibility Criteria is modified for both the tender. (2) **Tender No. 17261118** due on 17.04.2026 for procurement of FRP Modular Toilet Per Assembled without Lavatory Bowl facing regarding due date to be read as 27.04.2026 instead 17.04.2026. All other terms and conditions will remain the same.

PCMM
R.O. No.: 008-S/2026-27
Dated: 20.04.2026

IRAN TARGETED SHIPS IN THE STRAIT OVER WEEKEND

Over 3,300 people have died in Iran during war

DUBAI: Iran on Monday offered a new death toll for the war with Israel and the United States, with its forensic chief saying at least 3,375 people had been killed in the conflict.

The figure came from Abbas Masjedi, the head of Iran's Legal Medicine Organisation.

Masjedi, quoted by the judiciary's Mizan news agency and other outlets Monday, said only four of the dead remain unidentified. His comments did not break down casualties among civilians and security forces, instead just saying that 2,875 were male and 496 were female.

Masjedi said 383 of the dead were children 18 years old and under.

Masjedi's figures raised questions about whether or not they included security force members, particularly given the levels of intense bombings targeting military bases and arsenals in the country.

Meanwhile, the ceasefire in the Iran war hangs in the balance as Pakistan's capital stands prepared for possible new talks between Tehran and Washington.

As of right now, the two-week ceasefire will expire at 0000 GMT Wednesday (8 pm ET Tuesday.)

But the truce between



A woman walks past a billboard that shows a graphic depicting a military personnel's hand holding the Strait of Hormuz in his fist, in Vanak Square

AP/PTI

Highlights

- » The figure comes from Abbas Masjedi, the head of Iran's Legal Medicine Organisation
- » According to Masjedi, 383 of the dead were children 18 years old and under
- » The ceasefire in the Iran war hangs in the balance

Iran, Israel and the United States started after multiple deadlines posed by US President Donald Trump that threatened Iran's very "civilisation" at one point.

Further delays or sudden changes are likely to be the norm leading up to the deadline.

Serious challenges face the talks that may be held in Islam-

abad ahead of the ceasefire's expiration about the future of the Strait of Hormuz, Iran's nuclear programme and other issues.

Iran targeted ships in the Strait over the weekend.

The US also attacked and boarded one Iranian vessel that tried to outrun the American naval blockade in the strait — signalling that the situation remains volatile and a resumption of the war isn't out of the question.AGENCIES

UK calls for 'toll-free' Strait of Hormuz

LONDON: Britain on Monday called for a lasting settlement to ensure freedom of navigation and a toll-free Strait of Hormuz as the US-Iran ceasefire hung in the balance.

UK Foreign Secretary

Yvette Cooper arrived in Japan for the final leg of what has been branded as an "intensified shuttle diplomacy tour" to advance coordination with key allies on shared geopolitical, economic and energy security priorities.

During the six-day tour spanning Europe and West Asia, the British minister held in-person talks with Foreign Ministers from 11 countries, including Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt, the UAE, and Ukraine, concluding with a meeting

with the Japanese Foreign Minister for the annual Strategic Dialogue in Tokyo.

"The UK is grateful to Pakistan for the role they have been playing in facilitating diplomatic talks," she said. AGENCIES

UK PM Starmer in Parl showdown over US ambassador scandal

LONDON: British Prime Minister Keir Starmer on Monday said that he would have withdrawn the appointment of Peter Mandelson as the UK's Ambassador to the US if he had known Mandelson had not passed security checks.

Starmer made the remarks while addressing the House of Commons to present the timeline of his decision to appoint Mandelson as envoy to the US despite his scandalous links with American sex offender Jeffrey Epstein.

An embattled Starmer, fighting for his job, was forced to defend the move after it emerged that Mandelson had been given the green light for the diplomatic post despite failing the mandatory security vetting.

While the Opposition has questioned his judgment and accused him of misleading Parliament, the Prime Minister has insisted that he was never made aware of the failed

The Prime Minister has insisted that he was never made aware of the failed UK Security Vetting

UK Security Vetting (UKSV).

"If I had known before he took up his post that UKSV recommendation was that developed vetting clearance should be denied, I would not have gone ahead with the appointment," Starmer told MPs.

The UKSV recommended to the UK Foreign Office that clearance should be denied, but on the following day, officials overruled that to allow for the appointment to stand.

"Many members across the house will find these facts to be incredible. To that, I can only say they are right. It beggars belief that throughout the whole timeline of events, offi-

cials in the Foreign Office saw it fit to withhold this information from the most senior ministers in our system of government," said Starmer.

He said it's "absolutely unforgivable" that the foreign secretary was advised on, and allowed to sign a statement, without being told that the vetting security agency recommended Mandelson be denied clearance.

"The recommendation in the Peter Mandelson case could and should have been shared with me before he took up his post," he stressed.

After weeks of battling controversy over what he knew and when about the process, Starmer acknowledged that the "sensitive personal information" provided by appointees being vetted must be protected. However, he expressed his dismay that the appointing minister could not be told of the recommendation by UKSV. AGENCIES

France summons Elon Musk over alleged child abuse images on X

The world's richest man was summoned after a search took place in February at the French premises of X

PARIS: Elon Musk has been summoned to Paris on Monday, where investigators are looking into allegations of misconduct related to the social media platform X, including the spread of child sexual abuse material and deepfake content.

The world's richest man and Linda Yaccarino — the former CEO of X — have been summoned for "voluntary interviews," while other employees of the platform are scheduled to be heard as witnesses throughout this week, the Paris prosecutor's office said. It remains unclear whether Musk and Yaccarino will travel to Paris. A spokesperson for X did not respond to questions from The Associated Press and Yaccarino's current company, eMed, did not answer a request sent to the



Elon Musk

press email. French prosecutors also suspect that controversy around the platform's AI system Grok's deepfakes was concocted to boost the value of Musk-owned companies ahead of a key market listing, and alerted US authorities.

Musk welcomed a report that US justice officials refused to help French investigators, posting on X, "This needs to stop."

Musk was summoned after a search took place in Febru-

ary at the French premises of X as part of an investigation opened in January 2025 by the cybercrime unit of the Paris prosecutor's office. Musk and Yaccarino have been invited in their capacities as managers of X at the time of the events investigated. Yaccarino was CEO from May 2023 until July 2025. "These voluntary interviews with the executives are intended to allow them to present their position regarding the facts and, where appropriate, the compliance measures they plan to implement," prosecutors said.

"At this stage, the conduct of this investigation is part of a constructive approach, with the ultimate objective of ensuring that platform X complies with French law, insofar as it operates within the national territory." AGENCIES

Sensex & Nifty close almost flat in volatile trade as oil prices rebound

BSE SmallCap Select index fell 0.15% & MidCap Select index lost 0.12%

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty closed almost unchanged in a volatile session on Monday as investors turned cautious amid mounting geo-political headwinds and rising crude oil prices.

The 30-share BSE Sensex closed marginally up 26.76 points or 0.03 per cent at 78,520.30. During the day, it hit a high of 78,942.45 and a low of 78,203.30, gyrating 739.15 points.

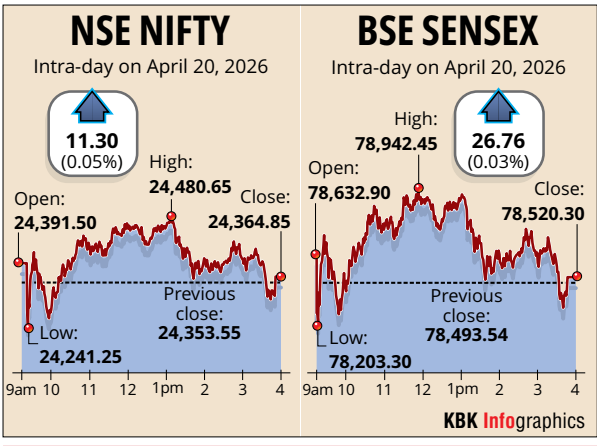
The 50-share NSE Nifty edged up 11.30 points or 0.05 per cent to settle at 24,364.85.

Among the 30-Sensex firms, Trent, State Bank of India, Asian Paints, NTPC, Bajaj Finance and InterGlobe Aviation were the major winners. Larsen & Toubro, Bharat Electronics, HCL Tech and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 4.76 per cent to \$94.68 per barrel.

“Renewed disputes over the reopening of the Strait of Hormuz injected volatility into global markets. Investors interpreted the recent disruptions in the Middle East as potential negotiation tactics rather than the onset of a full-scale conflict,” Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd.

With the ceasefire set to



Among the 30-Sensex firms, Trent, State Bank of India, Asian Paints, NTPC, Bajaj Finance and InterGlobe Aviation were the major winners. Larsen & Toubro, Bharat Electronics, HCL Tech and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the laggards

expire this week, market participants remain cautious, awaiting further developments, he added.

The BSE SmallCap Select index dipped 0.15 per cent and MidCap Select index lost 0.12 per cent.

Power jumped 1.24 per cent, followed by Utilities (0.88 per cent), PSU Bank (0.70 per cent) and Capital Goods (0.55 per cent). However, BSE Focused IT declined 0.93 per cent, IT (0.79

per cent), Realty (0.70 per cent), Telecommunication (0.66 per cent) and Commodities (0.34 per cent).

A total of 2,593 stocks declined, while 1,810 advanced and 175 remained unchanged on the BSE.

In Asian markets, South Korea's benchmark Kospi, Japan's Nikkei 225 index, Shanghai's SSE Composite index and Hong Kong's Hang Seng

Highlights

» A total of 2,593 stocks declined, while 1,810 advanced and 175 remained unchanged on the BSE

» Power jumped 1.24%, followed by Utilities (0.88%), PSU Bank (0.70%) and Capital Goods (0.55%)

» However, BSE Focused IT declined 0.93%, IT (0.79%), Realty (0.70%), Telecommunication (0.66%) and Commodities (0.34%)

» FIIs bought equities worth Rs 683.20 crore on Friday, according to exchange data

index ended higher. Markets in Europe were trading lower. US markets ended significantly higher on Friday.

FIIs bought equities worth Rs 683.20 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

On Friday, the Sensex jumped 504.86 points or 0.65 per cent to settle at 78,493.54. The Nifty climbed 156.80 points or 0.65 per cent to end at 24,353.55.

Rupee falls 25 paise to 93.16 against dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee pared its initial gains and settled with a loss of 25 paise at 93.16 against the US dollar on Monday, after fresh tension in West Asia led to an increased dollar demand.

Forex traders said the local currency remained under pressure due to a fresh standoff between the US and Iran that led to a closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

At the interbank forex market, the rupee opened at 92.73 & touched an intra-day high of 92.70 against dollar. The rupee finally settled at 93.16 against the dollar, registering a loss of 25 paise from previous close.

The rupee strengthened 28 paise to settle at 92.91 against the US dollar on Friday, a day after gaining 19 paise in the preceding session on Thursday.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, rose 0.14 per cent to 98.03. PII

States' capex growth to slow down to 8-10% in FY27: Report

'Revenue growth for States is likely to remain moderate through FY26 & FY27 on tapering of grants from Centre'

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: States' capital expenditure growth is likely to slow down to 8-10 per cent in FY27 from 17 per cent in FY26, a report said on Monday.

The moderation will primarily result from tighter fiscal headroom due to rising revenue expenditure commitments and a moderation in revenue growth, Careedge Ratings said.

The domestic rating agency warned that the moderation may be accentuated by a geo-political crisis in West Asia, explaining that the conflict's fall-out could hit capital outlays by exerting pressure on both revenues and expenditures through its impact on energy prices.

"With fiscal space becoming tighter due to rising revenue expenditure commitments and moderation in revenue growth, state capex growth is expected to moderate to around 8-10 per cent in FY27," the agency said.

Its associate director Prasanna Krishnan said the revenue growth for states is expected to remain moderate through FY26 and FY27 on a tapering of grants from the Centre, with external headwinds further weighing on overall receipts in FY27. However, the revenue expenditure is likely to stay elevated, driven by continued social sector spending, a higher state share under select schemes, and additional inflationary pressures from elevated commodity and fuel prices amid the West Asia conflict.

"The revenue deficit is projected to widen from 0.8 per cent of GDP in FY25 to around 1.2 per cent by FY27. Maintaining fiscal discipline will therefore remain critical as states balance welfare commitments with the need to sustain capital investment," Krishnan said.

The agency elaborated that revenue receipts are projected to grow by 6.2 per cent in FY26 and 7.9 per cent in FY27, trailing nominal Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP), due to



'However, revenue expenditure likely to remain elevated, driven by continued social sector spending, higher state share under select schemes and inflationary pressures'

tionary pressures from elevated commodity and fuel prices amid the West Asia conflict.

"The revenue deficit is projected to widen from 0.8 per cent of GDP in FY25 to around 1.2 per cent by FY27. Maintaining fiscal discipline will therefore remain critical as states balance welfare commitments with the need to sustain capital investment," Krishnan said.

The agency elaborated that revenue receipts are projected to grow by 6.2 per cent in FY26 and 7.9 per cent in FY27, trailing nominal Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP), due to

Key Points

» 'The revenue deficit is projected to widen from 0.8 per cent of GSDP in FY25 to around 1.2% by FY27'

» 'Maintaining fiscal discipline will therefore remain critical as states balance welfare commitments with the need to sustain capital investment'

» 'Revenue receipts are projected to grow by 6.2 per cent in FY26 and 7.9 per cent in FY27, trailing nominal GSDP'

moderation in grants and some sensitivity to external factors that may weigh on overall revenue realisations.

Prominent states such as Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Maharashtra and Telangana have continued to prioritise capex despite moderate revenue growth, reflecting a sustained focus on infrastructure creation, the agency said.

The agency said it has analysed the finances of the top 15 states, which account for 89 per cent of India's GSDP for FY25, to provide insights on aggregate state finances.

Silver jumps to ₹2.57L/kg, gold rises to ₹1.57L/10 gms



NEW DELHI: Silver prices climbed Rs 4,300 to Rs 2.57 lakh per kilogram in the national capital on Monday, while gold advanced to Rs 1.57 lakh per 10 grams on fresh buying by retailers and stockists.

According to the All India Sarafa Association, the white metal jumped Rs 4,300 to Rs 2,57,300 per kg (inclusive of all taxes) from Friday's closing level of Rs 2,53,000 per kg.

Gold of 99.9 per cent purity also gained Rs 800 to Rs 1,57,000 per 10 grams (inclusive of all taxes). The yellow metal had finished at Rs 1,56,200 per 10 grams in the previous market session.

However, global trends remained subdued. Spot silver slipped \$1.09, or 1.35 per cent, to \$79.71 per ounce, and gold was traded 0.52 per cent to \$4,805.09 per ounce.

"Gold started the week on a weaker note, reflecting a shift in geopolitical and macro conditions over the weekend," Saumil Gandhi, Senior Analyst of Commodities at HDFC Securities, said.

Meanwhile, investors are expected to closely track key global macroeconomic indicators this week. PII

Govt buys back ₹12,686.974 crore in Reserve Bank's G-sec auction

MUMBAI: The Government of India bought back government securities (G-secs) worth Rs 12,686.974 crore from the switch auction conducted by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday, and issued bonds worth Rs 13,311.383 crore.

Two securities repurchased by the government were part of the scheduled bonds set to mature later this financial year. These included Rs 2,316 crore of 5.74 per cent GS 2026, and Rs 1,000 crore of 8.24 per cent GS 2027.

Other securities repurchased by the government are maturing in FY28, FY29, and FY30.

The government repurchased securities worth Rs 3,000 crore of 6.79 per cent GS 2027, Rs 1,640.594 crore



Other securities repurchased by the government are maturing in FY28, FY29, and FY30

of 8.60 per cent GS 2028, Rs 3,000 crore of 7.59 per cent GS 2029, and Rs 1,730.380 crore of 7.10 per cent GS 2029, the release said.

However, the government did not accept any bids for 6.64 per cent GS 2027, 7.04 per cent

GS 2029, and 7.88 per cent GS 2030.

The switch operation is expected to ease redemption pressure in the next financial year, when government bond maturities worth Rs 5.47 lakh crore are due. With gross market borrowing already budgeted at Rs 17.2 lakh crore, the move helps smoothen the maturity profile and manage repayment obligations more effectively.

The central government budgeted net market borrowing at Rs 11.7 lakh crore for FY27, around Rs 50,000 crore higher than FY26. Gross market borrowing has been set at Rs 17.2 lakh crore, which is sharply higher than the current year. This increase is largely due to higher maturities scheduled for FY27. PII

Sebi cuts minimum investment to ₹1K for social impact funds to broaden retail participation

NEW DELHI: Markets regulator Sebi has sharply reduced the minimum investment required from individual investors in social impact funds to Rs 1,000 from the existing Rs 2 lakh, in a bid to widen retail participation on the Social Stock Exchange (SSE).

"This would align the minimum application size requirement for subscribing to Zero Coupon Zero Principal Instruments under Sebi's ICDR (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018 with the minimum investment value requirement for individual investors in Social Impact Fund.

Earlier, AIF rules required individual investors to invest

a minimum of Rs 2 lakh in a social impact fund that invests in securities of NPOs listed or registered on the SSE.

Now, in its notification dated April 16, Sebi reduced this threshold to Rs 1,000.

To give this effect, Sebi has amended the Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) rules.

Additionally, Sebi also said AIFs, which do not retain any funds after the expiry of their fund life may be permitted to seek an "inactive" status, subject to compliance with prescribed norms.

"An Alternative Investment Fund may be tagged as an inactive fund, in such manner and subject to conditions as may be specified by the Board from

time to time," Sebi said.

The move is premised on the principle that while entry into the securities market is subject to specified eligibility criteria, the regulatory framework for exit -- where an entity seeks to discontinue its activities -- should be clear, predictable and operationally efficient.

Earlier, Sebi extended the registration validity for not-for-profit organisations on the Social Stock Exchange, allowing their enrolment as NPOs for three years without raising funds, and lowered the minimum subscription requirement for issuing zero coupon zero principal instruments (ZCZP).

Sebi extended the validity period to three years from

the existing two, during which NPOs can remain registered on the SSE without raising funds.

Additionally, the regulator lowered the minimum subscription requirement for zero coupon zero principal instruments to 50 per cent from 75 per cent to enhance fundraising flexibility for NPOs.

This relaxation would apply only to projects where costs and outcomes can be implemented on a clearly identifiable per-unit basis, ensuring that partial subscription does not adversely affect project execution, Sebi stated. In separate notifications, Sebi amended norms governing REITs (real estate investment trusts) & infrastructure investment trusts (InvITs). PII

Groww posts two-fold jump in profit to ₹686 crore in Q4

NEW DELHI: Billionbrains Garage Ventures, the parent company of stock broking firm Groww, on Monday reported an over two-fold growth in profit after tax to Rs 686 crore for the three months ended March 2026. The company had posted a PAT of Rs 309 crore in the same quarter preceding fiscal.

Its total income surged 81 per cent year-on-year to Rs 1,536 crore in the quarter under review from Rs 850 crore in the January-March quarter of 2025, Bengaluru-headquartered Groww said in a stock exchange filing.

The firm's total transacting users stood at 2.16 crore at the end of the March quarter, marking a 25 per cent year-on-year (YoY) growth. Its active user

base stood at 1.67 crore.

Further, its total customer assets accelerated 36 per cent year-on-year to Rs 3 lakh crore.

"Operating leverage played out across all the cost buckets, leading to PAT margin expanding by 8.3 per cent YoY ...and an absolute PAT margin of 44.7 per cent in Q4. As the revenue increases faster than the costs, which are largely fixed in nature, the margins will keep expanding," the company said.

For the full fiscal year FY26, Groww's PAT grew 14 per cent year-on-year to Rs 2,083 crore and total income rose 19 per cent year-on-year to Rs 4,816 crore. Founded in 2016, Groww emerged as country's largest stockbroker, with over 28 per cent market share. PII

Postal Department posts revenue of ₹15,296 cr for FY26, up 16% from a year ago

Announcing revenue scorecard after Postal Department's annual business meet, Scindia said year has been "historic" for department

NEW DELHI: The Department of Post has clocked revenue of Rs 15,296 crore for financial year 2025-26, a 16 per cent growth year-on-year, Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia said on Monday.

Announcing the revenue scorecard after the Postal Department's annual business meet here, Scindia said the year has been "historic" for the department. He said that with sharp focus on deepening the reach of services, acquisition of customers and six sigma service level agreements with customers, the department is aiming for higher growth for FY27.

"...so it has been a very historic year for the Department of Post...as you are aware, we've also come out with three new products. We are now looking at increasing the penetration of many of our services, acquiring new customers, performing against very strict 'Six Sigma' service level agreements with all our clients to post an even greater growth rate over the next fiscal year," Scindia told reporters.

The revenue for FY25 stood at Rs 13,218 crore, and in 2025-26, the topline number increased to 15,296 crore. "That is a growth rate of 16

CLOSER LOOK

» The revenue for FY25 stood at Rs 13,218 crore, and in 2025-26, the topline number increased to 15,296 crore

» Post office Savings Bank posted Rs 7,756 crore in just-concluded fiscal, growing at 13%, the minister said

» Postal life insurance & rural postal life insurance has grown to Rs 1,458 crore up 25% year-on-year

per cent. We have hit upwards of 15 per cent growth rate in probably long time in this department," the minister said.

Eight circles out of 23 have achieved greater than 90 per cent of their target, 14 circles met between 80 to 90 per cent

of their target, and only one circle is less than 80 per cent of their target, Scindia said that the performance underlines "a major transformation" in the way the Department operates as a service driven organisation.

Among the verticals, parcels grew to Rs 1,133 crore in FY26, about 69 per cent higher than the last fiscal, driven by stellar show from Jharkhand, Telangana, and Gujarat.

"On mails, which is the second vertical, from Rs 2,396 crore revenue in FY 24-25 we've now grown to Rs 3,202 crore, which is a growth of 34 per cent," Scindia said, adding that growth was driven by Rajasthan, Assam and Jammu & Kashmir.

The international mail category faced "major problems" on account of global disruptions. Citizen centric services grew to Rs 864 crore revenue in FY26, growing 70 per cent

over previous fiscal.

Post office Savings Bank posted Rs 7,756 crore in just-concluded fiscal, growing at 13 per cent, the minister said and added postal life insurance and rural postal life insurance has grown to Rs 1,458 crore, a growth of 25 per cent year-on-year.

Speaking to reporters, Vandita Kaul, Secretary, Department of Posts said that the "gap" between expenditure (excluding pensions) and revenue has narrowed in FY26 by about Rs 1,500 crore, even as the Department has maintained a sharp focus and commitment to universal service obligation.

Revenue expenditure with pension for FY26 came to about Rs 38,631 crore. Kaul said about one-third of the Postal Department's overall expenditure is towards pension. Excluding pensions, she said, the expenditure stands at Rs 26,559 crore, and given that revenue receipts are at Rs 15,296 crore in FY26, the deficit/gap is at about Rs 11,000 crore. The deficit was about Rs 12,500 crore in the previous fiscal. Over the next five years, the Department is looking to bridge the gap between income and expenditure "fully", she asserted. PII

BoM Q4 profit rises by 35% to ₹2,014 crore



NEW DELHI: State-owned Bank of Maharashtra on Monday reported a 35 per cent rise in net profit to Rs 2,014 crore in Q4 FY26.

The bank had earned a net profit of Rs 1,493 crore in the year-ago period.

During the quarter, the bank's total income increased to Rs 8,693 crore against Rs 7,711 crore a year ago, the bank said in a regulatory filing.

Interest income grew to Rs 7,755 crore during the period under review, from Rs 6,731 crore in the corresponding quarter a year ago.

On the asset quality side, gross Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) declined to 1.45 per cent of gross advances as of March 2026 from 1.74 per cent by the end of March 2025.

Net NPAs also came down to 0.13 per cent of the advances from 0.18 per cent at the end of 2025.

Return on Assets (ROA) improved to 1.86 per cent for the year ended March 2026 against 1.75 per cent at the end of previous fiscal. However, the bank's capital adequacy ratio declined to 18.36 per cent as against 20.53 per cent at the end of FY25. PII

Format C-1
(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases
(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)
Name and address of candidate: **Naresh Chandra Bauri, resident of Jambuni, Ward No. 06, P.O+P.S- Bolpur, District- Birbhum, PIN- 731204.**
Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)
Name of Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL, 2026**
*Name of Constituency: – **284 Dubrajpur (SC) Assembly Constituency**
I, **Naresh Chandra Bauri**, a candidate for the abovementioned election, declares for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

A. Pending Criminal Cases				
S l . No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
a.	Learned ACJM Court, Bolpur	Illambazar PS Case No. 17 of 2022 dated 18.01.2022	Charges not framed	Alleged offences under Sections 467/ 468/ 471/ 420/ 506/ 34 IPC, 1860- (Forgery of valuable security, will, etc., Forgery for purpose of cheating, Using as genuine a forged document or electronic record, Cheating and dishonestly inducing delivery of property, Punishment for criminal intimidation, Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.)
b.	Learned CJM Court, Purba Bardhaman	Purba Bardhaman PS Case no. 796 of 2022 dated 18.07.2022	Charges framed dated 17.08.2020 (Charge Sheet No. 1438/22)	Alleged offences under Sections 448/ 333/ 379/ 506/ 354/ 34 IPC, 1860 and Sections 25/27 Arms Act, 1959- (Punishment for criminal trespass, Voluntarily causing grievous hurt to deter public servant from his duty, Punishment for theft, Punishment for criminal intimidation. If threat be to cause death or grievous hurt, etc, Assault of criminal to woman with intent to outrage her modesty, Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention, Punishment for certain offences, Punishment for using arms, etc.)
c.	Learned ACJM Court, Bolpur	Santiniketan PS Case No. 123/2020 dated 17.08.2020	Charges not framed	Alleged offences under Sections 448/ 323/ 379/ 506/ 354/ 34 IPC, 1860- (Punishment for house-trespass, Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt, Punishment for theft, Punishment for criminal intimidation. If threat be to cause death or grievous hurt, etc, Assault of criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty, Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.)
d.	Learned ACJM Court, Bolpur	Santiniketan PS Case No. 265/2025 dated 27.09.2025	Charges not framed	Alleged offences under Sections 338/ 336(3)/ 340(2)/ 318(2)/ 3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 – (Forgery of valuable security, will, etc, Forgery, Forged document or electronic record and using it as genuine, Cheating, When a criminal act is done by several persons in furtherance of the common intention of all, each of such persons is liable for that act in the same manner as if it were done by him alone.)
B. Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences				
S l . No.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed	
1.	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.

Format C-1
(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases
(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)
Name and address of candidate: **Ujjal Chatterjee, resident of Lalkuthipara, Suri, Birbhum, West Bengal- 731101.**
Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)
Name of Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL, 2026**
*Name of Constituency: – **285-Suri Assembly Constituency**
I, **Ujjal Chatterjee** a candidate for the abovementioned election, declares for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

A. Pending Criminal Cases				
S l . No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
a.	Learned ADJ, 1st Court, Birbhum	SPL (Atrocity) 19/25 (arising out Suri P.S. Case No. 448/25 dated 04.08.2025)	Charges not framed.	Alleged offences under Sections 329(3)/ 115(2)/ 117(2)/ 351(2)/ 3(5) of Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 – (Criminal trespass and house-trespass, Voluntarily causing hurt, Voluntarily causing grievous hurt, Criminal intimidation, When a criminal act is done by several persons in furtherance of the common intention of all, each of such persons is liable for that act in the same manner as if it were done by him alone.)
b.	Learned ADJ, 1st Court, Birbhum	SPL (Atrocity) 18/25 (arising out of Suri P.S. Case No. 447/25 dated 04.08.2025)	Charges not framed.	Alleged offences under Sections 3(i)(r)(s)(u) of SC & ST(POA) Act 1989- (Compels a member of a Scheduled Caste or a Scheduled Tribe to dispose or carry human or animal carcasses, or to dig graves, Intentionally insults or intimidates with intent to humiliate a member of a Scheduled Caste or a Scheduled Tribe in any place within public view, Abuses any member of a Scheduled Caste or a Scheduled Tribe by caste name in any place within public view, By words either written or spoken or by signs or by visible representation or otherwise promotes or attempts to promote feelings of enmity, hatred or ill-will against members of the Scheduled Castes or the Scheduled Tribes.)
B. Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences				
S l . No.	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed	
1.	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.



Format C-1

(for candidate to publish in Newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal cases

(As per the judgment dated 25thSeptember,2018, of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)

Name and address of candidate: **Subrata Dutta, resident of, Village – Patrasayer, P.O. – Patrasayer, P.S. – Patrasayer, Dist. – Bankura, PIN – 722206, West Bengal.**

Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**

(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)

Name of Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL, 2026**

*Name of Constituency: – **254- Onda Assembly Constituency**

I, **Subrata Dutta**, a candidate for the abovementioned election, declares for public information the following details about my criminal antecedents:

A. Pending criminal cases				
Sl No.	Name of Court	Case No. and dated	Status of case(s)	Section(s) of Acts concerned and brief description of offence(s)
1.	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 1618 of 25 arising out of PS Case No. 276/2025, dated 08/11/2025, Patrasayer Police Station	Charges not framed,	Alleged offences under Sections 126(2)/115(2)/118(1)/117(2)/109/76/ 324(4)/303(2)/351(2)(3)/3(5) of B.N.S, 2023. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means.Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means, attempt to murder, Assault or use of criminal force to woman with intent to disrobe. Punishment for mischief thereby causes loss or damage to the amount of twenty thousand rupees and more but less than one lakh. Punishment for theft, Punishment for Criminal intimidation,Criminal act done by several persons in furtherance of the common intention of all, each of such persons is liable for that act in the same manner as if it were done by him alone.
2	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 1123 of 17 arising out of PS Case No. 284/2017, dated 19/11/2017, PatrasayerPolice Station	Charges not framed,	Alleged offences under Sections 147/148/149/337/338 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860, and Sections 3/4 of E.S. Act 1908. Punishment for rioting. Punishment for rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Causing hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others. Causing grievous hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others. Punishment for causing explosion likely to endanger life or property. Punishment for attempt to cause explosion, or for making or keeping explosive with intent to endanger life or property.
3	Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 496 of 17 arising out of PS Case No. 92/2017, dated 14/05/2017, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed,	Alleged offences under Sections341/323/325/308/379/427/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Punishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
4	Learned ACJM Bishnupur,	G.R. Case NO. 475/17, arising out of FIR No. 88/2017, dt. 07.05.2017, Patrasayer police Station	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/324/325/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means, punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt, punishment for criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
5	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 258/17, arising out FIR No. 44/2017, dt. 15.03.2017, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/325/506/308/379 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And section 25/27 of the Arms Act. Punishment for unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Punishment for theft. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.
6	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 1177/16, arising out FIR No. 239/2016, dt. 10.12.2016, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/341/323/424/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Dishonest or fraudulent removal or concealment of property. Criminal intimidation.
7	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 1107/16, arising out FIR No. 233/2016, dt. 21.11.2016, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 148/149/341/323/325/308/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And sections 9(b) I.E act and sections 25 & 27 of the Arms Act. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of any prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.
8	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 323/16, arising out FIR No. 74/2016, dt. 10.04.2016, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/325/326/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Criminal intimidation.
9	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 212/15, arising out FIR No. 65/2015, dt. 14.03.2015, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/506/186/353/332 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt, punishment for criminal intimidation, obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions, assault or criminal force to deter public servant from discharge of his duty, voluntarily causing hurt to deter public servant from his duty.
10	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 83/15, arising out FIR No. 25/2015, dt. 22.01.2015, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges framed, on 23.09.2024.	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/354/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.
11	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 773/14, arising out FIR No. 157/2014, dt. 26.12.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/341/323 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapons. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt.
12	Learned ACJM, Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 702/14, arising out FIR No. 133/2014, dt. 26.11.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation.
13	Learned ADJ Bishnupur,	S.C.No.- 07(12) 19, arising out FIR No. 103/2014, dt. 12.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 376/306/506/509/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rape. Abetment of suicide. Criminal intimidation. Word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
14	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 616/14, arising out FIR No. 100/2014, dt. 01.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/324/354/147/148/149/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.

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15	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 561/14, arising out FIR No. 90/2014, dt. 12.09.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
16	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 529/14, arising out FIR No. 79/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/448/427/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. House-trespass. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation.
17	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 508/14, arising out FIR No. 78/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/143 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Punishment for Unlawful assembly.
18	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 390/14, arising out FIR No. 61/2014, dt. 14.06.2014, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/323/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.
19	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 772/10, arising out FIR No. 114/2010, dt. 15.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/326/379/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for Theft. Criminal intimidation.
20	Learned ACJM, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 760/10, arising out FIR No. 110/2010, dt. 12.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
21	Learned ACJM, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 757/10, arising out FIR No. 108/2010, dt. 11.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/186 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E act & 9 MPO. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Preventive measures for maintenance of public order.
22	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 748/10, arising out FIR No. 105/2010, dt. 07.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/324/325/326/379/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for theft. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.
23	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 696/10, arising out FIR No. 98/2010, dt. 20.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Criminal intimidation.
24	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 695/10, arising out FIR No. 97/2010, dt. 13.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/324/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E Act Sections 3(i)(ii) 10 (ii) of SC & ST Act. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Used words, acts or gesture of a sexual nature towards a woman belonging to a schedule caste/ schedule tribe, knowing that she belongs to a schedule caste/schedule tribe.
25	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 644/10, arising out FIR No. 92/2010, dt. 03.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/448/324/323/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 9(b) of the I.E Act Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for House-trespass. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition.
26	Learned 11th Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	N.G.R. Case No. 139/11, arising out NCR No. 268/2010, dt. 02.10.2010, Patrasayer Police Station	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Section 506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for criminal intimidation.
27	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur	G.R. Case No. 428/10, arising out FIR No. 58/2010, dt. 15.08.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/324/325/323/326/307/379/ of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b)I.E. Act, Sections 25 & 27 ARMS Act. Punishment for rioting, Rioting, armed with deadly weapon, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Attempt to murder. Punishment for theft. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.
28	Learned ACJM Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 377/10, arising out FIR No. 47/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/325/364/365 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, rioting while armed with deadly weapons, unlawful assembly with common object, voluntarily causing hurt, voluntarily causing grievous hurt, and kidnapping/abduction with intent to murder or to secretly and wrongfully confine a person.
29	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 376/10, arising out FIR No. 46/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/186/353/332/224/225/333/379/427/506/307 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting, rioting armed with a deadly weapon; every member of an unlawful assembly guilty of an offence committed in prosecution of the common object; obstructing a public servant in discharge of public functions; assault or criminal force to deter a public servant from discharge of duty; voluntarily causing hurt to deter a public servant from duty; voluntarily causing grievous hurt to deter a public servant from duty; resistance or obstruction by a person to his lawful apprehension; resistance or obstruction to the lawful apprehension of another person; theft; mischief causing damage; criminal intimidation; and attempt to murder.
30	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 220/10, arising out FIR No. 34/2010, dt. 04.05.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges Not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/452/323/354/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. House-trespass after preparation for hurt, assault or wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.
31	Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 216/10, arising out FIR No. 32/2010, dt. 28.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges Not framed	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/448/379/363 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. House-trespass. Punishment for theft. Kidnapping.
32	Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur.	G.R. Case No. 163/10, arising out FIR No. 21/2010, dt. 04.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station.	Charges framedon, 02.05.2015	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/323/341/354/379/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Punishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.
B.	Details about cases of conviction for criminal offences			
Sl. No	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punishment imposed	Maximum Punishment Imposed	
1.	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	NOT APPLICABLE	

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.



Format C-2

(For political party to publish in website, newspapers, TV)

Declaration about criminal antecedents of candidates set up by the party
(As per the judgment dated 25th September, 2018 of Hon’ble Supreme Court in WP (Civil) No. 536 of 2011 (Public Interest Foundation & Ors. Vs. Union of India &Anr.)
Name of political party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**
(Independent candidates should write “Independent” here)
Name of Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL, 2026**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

1	2	3	4		5		
Sl No.	Name of constituency	Name of candi-date	(A) Pending criminal cases		(B) Details about cases of con-viction for criminal offences		
			Name of Court, case No. & status of the case(s)	Sections of the Acts concerned & brief description of offence(s)	Name of Court & date(s) of order(s)	Description of offence(s) & punish-ment imposed	Maxi-mum Punish-ment Imposed
1	254- Onda Assembly Constitu-ency	Subrata Dutta	a. Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnu-pur, G.R. Case No. 1618 of 25 arising out of PS Case No. 276/2025, dated 08/11/2025, Patrasayer Police Station, Charges not framed.	a. Alleged offences under Sections 126(2)/115(2)/118(1)/117(2)/109/76/324(4)/303(2)/351(2)(3)/3(5) of B.N.S, 2023. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt by danger-ous weapons or means. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means, Attempt to murder, Assault or use of criminal force to woman with intent to disrobe. Punishment for mischief thereby causes loss or damage to the amount of twenty thousand rupees and more but less than one lakh. Punishment for theft, Pun-ishment for Criminal intimidation.	a.N/A	a.N/A	a.N/A
			b.Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnu-pur, G.R. Case No. 1123 of 17 arising out of PS Case No. 284/2017, dated 19/11/2017, Patrasayer Police Station, Charges not framed.	b. Alleged offences under Sections 147/148/149/337/338 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860, and Sections 3/4 of E.S. Act 1908. Punishment for rioting. Punishment for rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every mem-ber of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Causing hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others. Causing grievous hurt by act endangering life or personal safety of others.	b. N/A	b. N/A	b. N/A
			c. Learned Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur, G.R. Case No. 496 of 17 (arising out of PS Case No. 92/2017, dated 14/05/2017, Patrasayer Police Station) Charges not framed	c. Alleged offences under Sections 341/323/325/308/379/427/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punish-ment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Pun-ishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	c. N/A	c. N/A	c. N/A
			d. Learned ACJM Bishnupur, G.R. Case NO. 475/17, aris-ing out of FIR No. 88/2017, dt. 07.05.2017, Patrasayer police Station Charges not framed	d. Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/324/325/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means, punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt, punishment for criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	d.N/A	d.N/A	d.N/A
			e. Learned 3rd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 258/17, aris-ing out FIR No. 44/2017, dt. 15.03.2017, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	e. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/325/506/308/379 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And section 25/27 of the Arms Act. Punishment for Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Punishment for theft. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.	e.N/A	e.N/A	e.N/A
			f. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 1177/16, aris-ing out FIR No. 239/2016, dt. 10.12.2016, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	f. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/341/323/424/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Dishonest or fraudulent removal or concealment of property. Criminal intimidation.	f.N/A	f.N/A	f.N/A
			g. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 1107/16, aris-ing out FIR No. 233/2016, dt. 21.11.2016, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	g. Alleged Offences under Sections – 148/149/341/323/325/308/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. And sections 9(b) I.E act and sections 25 & 27 of the Arms Act. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punish-ment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Attempt to commit culpable homicide. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of any prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.	g.N/A	g.N/A	g.N/A
			h. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 323/16, aris-ing out FIR No. 74/2016, dt. 10.04.2016, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	h. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/325/326506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Criminal intimidation.	h.N/A	h.N/A	h.N/A
			i. Learned 3rd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 212/15, aris-ing out FIR No. 65/2015, dt. 14.03.2015, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	i. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/506/186/353/332 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt, punishment for crimi-nal intimidation, obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions, assault or criminal force to deter public servant from discharge of his duty, voluntarily causing hurt to deter public servant from his duty.	i.N/A	i.N/A	i.N/A
			j. Learned 3rd Judicial Mag-istrate, Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 83/15, arising out FIR No. 25/2015, dt. 22.01.2015, Patra-sayer Police Station. Charges framed, on 23.09.2024.	j. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/354/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.	j.N/A	j.N/A	j.N/A
			k. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 773/14, arising out FIR No. 157/2014, dt. 26.12.2014, Patrasayer Police Sta-tion. Charges	k. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/341/323 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapons. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt.	k.N/A	k.N/A	k.N/A
			l. Learned ACJM, Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 702/14, aris-ing out FIR No. 133/2014, dt. 26.11.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	l. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/149/323/325/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 Rioting. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Criminal intimidation.	l.N/A	l.N/A	l.N/A
			m. Learned ADJ Bishnupur, S.C.No.- 07(12) 19, aris-ing out FIR No. 103/2014, dt. 12.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station Charged not framed	m. Alleged Offences under Sections – 376/306/506/509/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for Rape. Abetment of suicide. Criminal intimidation. Word, gesture or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	m.N/A	m.N/A	m.N/A
			n. Learned 2nd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 616/14, aris-ing out FIR No. 100/2014, dt. 01.10.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	n. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/324/354/147/148/149/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily caus-ing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	n.N/A	n.N/A	n.N/A
			o. Learned 3rd Judicial Magis-trate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 561/14, aris-ing out FIR No. 90/2014, dt. 12.09.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	o. Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	o.N/A	o.N/A	o.N/A

continue next page

			p. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 529/14, arising out FIR No. 79/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	p. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/448/427/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for House-trespass. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation.	p.N/A	p.N/A	p.N/A
			q. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 508/14, arising out FIR No. 78/2014, dt. 13.08.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	q. Alleged Offences under Sections – 341/323/506/143 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Punishment for Unlawful assembly.	q.N/A	q.N/A	q.N/A
			r. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 390/14, arising out FIR No. 61/2014, dt. 14.06.2014, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	r. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/323/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more.	r.N/A	r.N/A	r.N/A
			s. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 772/10, arising out FIR No. 114/2010, dt. 15.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	s. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/323/326/379/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for theft. Criminal intimidation.	s.N/A	s.N/A	s.N/A
			t. Learned ACJM, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 760/10, arising out FIR No. 110/2010, dt. 12.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	t. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	t.N/A	t.N/A	t.N/A
			u. Learned ACJM, Bishnupur G.R. Case No. 757/10, arising out FIR No. 108/2010, dt. 11.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	u. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/186 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E act & 9 MPO. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapons. Every member of unlawful assembly is guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Obstructing public servant in discharge of public functions. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Preventive measures for maintenance of public order.	u.N/A	u.N/A	u.N/A
			v. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Bishnupur, G.R. Case No. 748/10, arising out FIR No. 105/2010, dt. 07.12.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	v. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/323/324/325/326/379/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for theft. Criminal intimidation. Acts done by several persons in furtherance of common intention.	v.N/A	v.N/A	v.N/A
			w. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 696/10, arising out FIR No. 98/2010, dt. 20.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	w. Alleged Offences under Sections – 143/341/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Unlawful assembly. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Criminal intimidation.	w.N/A	w.N/A	w.N/A
			x. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 695/10, arising out FIR No. 97/2010, dt. 13.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	x. Alleged Offences under Sections – 147/148/149/323/324/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b) I.E Act Sections 3(i)(ii) 10 (ii) of SC & ST Act. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Used words, acts or gesture of a sexual nature towards a woman belonging to a schedule caste/ schedule tribe, knowing that she belongs to a schedule caste/schedule tribe.	x.N/A	x.N/A	x.N/A
			y. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 644/10, arising out FIR No. 92/2010, dt. 03.11.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	y. Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/448/324/323/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 9(b) of the I.E Act Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for House-trespass. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition.	y.N/A	y.N/A	y.N/A
			z. Learned 11th Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. N.G.R. Case No. 139/11, arising out NCR No. 268/2010, dt. 02.10.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	z. Alleged Offenceunder Section 506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for criminal intimidation.	z.N/A	z.N/A	z.N/A
			aa.Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 428/10, arising out FIR No. 58/2010, dt. 15.08.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed	aa.Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/324/325/323/326/307/379/ of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Section 9(b)I.E. Act, Sections 25 & 27 ARMS Act. Punishment for rioting, Rioting, armed with deadly weapon, every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Voluntarily causing hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Punishment for voluntarily causing grievous hurt. Voluntarily causing grievous hurt by dangerous weapons or means. Attempt to murder. Punishment for theft. Acquisition, possession or carrying of prohibited arms or ammunition. Punishment for certain offences relating to arms. Punishment for using arms.	aa.N/A	aa.N/A	aa.N/A
			ab. Learned ACJM Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 377/10, arising out FIR No. 47/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	ab. Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/325/364/365 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Punishment for rioting, rioting while armed with deadly weapons, unlawful assembly with common object, voluntarily causing hurt, voluntarily causing grievous hurt, and kidnapping/ abduction with intent to murder or to secretly and wrongfully confine a person.	ab.N/A	ab.N/A	ab.N/A
			ac. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 376/10, arising out FIR No. 46/2010, dt. 28.07.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	ac. Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/186/353/332/224/225/333/379/427/506/3 07 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. rioting; rioting armed with a deadly weapon; every member of an unlawful assembly guilty of an offence committed in prosecution of the common object; obstructing a public servant in discharge of public functions; assault or criminal force to deter a public servant from discharge of duty; voluntarily causing hurt to deter a public servant from duty; voluntarily causing grievous hurt to deter a public servant from duty; resistance or obstruction by a person to his lawful apprehension; resistance or obstruction to the lawful apprehension of another person; theft; mischief causing damage; criminal intimidation; and attempt to murder.	ac.N/A	ac.N/A	ac.N/A
			ad. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 220/10, arising out FIR No. 34/2010, dt. 04.05.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	ad.Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/452/323/354/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. House-trespass after preparation for hurt, assault or wrongful restraint. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.	ad.N/A	ad.N/A	ad.N/A
			ae. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 216/10, arising out FIR No. 32/2010, dt. 28.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges not framed.	Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/149/323/448/379/363 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Every member of unlawful assembly guilty of offence committed in prosecution of common object. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. House-trespass. Punishment for theft. Kidnapping.	ae.N/A	ae.N/A	ae.N/A
			af. Learned 2nd Judicial Magistrate Bishnupur. G.R. Case No. 163/10, arising out FIR No. 21/2010, dt. 04.04.2010, Patrasayer Police Station. Charges framed no 02.05.2015.	af.Alleged Offences under Sections 147/148/323/341/354/379/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Rioting. Rioting, armed with deadly weapon. Punishment for voluntarily causing hurt. Punishment for wrongful restraint. Assault or criminal force to woman with intent to outrage her modesty. Punishment for theft. Mischief causing damage to the amount of fifty rupees or more. Criminal intimidation.	af.N/A	af.N/A	af.N/A

*In the case of election to Council of States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of constituency.



Tilak turns Titan

Varma's maiden century scripts memorable turnaround for MI

AHMEDABAD: Tilak Varma played a knock for the ages as his maiden IPL century turned the corner for Mumbai Indians with the five-time champions crushing Gujarat Titans by 99 runs here on Monday.

Spurred by skipper Hardik Pandya's 'hard talk' asking him to get a move-on during the strategic break after he scratched his way to 19 off 22 balls, Tilak changed gears in a flash to amass 82 off the next 23 deliveries and end on an unbeaten 101 off 45 balls.

Mumbai Indians' 199 for 5 was good enough as Jasprit Bumrah broke his wicket-less streak for five matches with a first-ball dismissal of Sai Sudharsan and GT never recovered from there to get all out for 100 in 15.5 overs.

The introduction of left-arm seamer Ashwani Kumar proved to be decisive as he snared 4 for 24 to run through the middle-order along with Mitchell Santner (2/16 in 3 overs).

The defeat also exposed the chinks in GT armoury, especially their fragile middle-order where they have carried two 'non performing assets' in Rahul Tewatia and M Shahrukh Khan for the longest time.

Between them, they played 24 balls and scored only 25



Tilak Varma remained not out on 101 off 45 balls

PTI

82

Runs Tilak Varma scored in the last six overs, the most by any batter in IPL

runs and it is baffling to see head coach Ashish Nehra placing so much faith in the mediocre duo.

The win, after four straight defeats, took Mumbai Indians to seventh place in the points table, but more importantly, it improved their net run rate significantly (+0.067).

MI looked a different outfit till the 14th over when the second strategic time out was taken. Post that, Tilak did the unthinkable to give the total respectability, which looked

spell by Kagiso Rabada.

At the strategic time-out post 14th over, TV cameras caught skipper Pandya animatedly telling something to Tilak, who had looked unconvincing till that point of time and was occasionally booed by the crowd. But after that break, one saw the Tilak that one has always known as he threw the kitchen sink at GT's fastest bowlers. Prasidh Krishna went for 19, and new pace sensation Ashok Sharma was toyed with for 26 runs.

AGENCIES

improbable after the powerplay thanks to an intimidating first

65 kg king? Kalkal has a firm grip on winning

NEW DELHI: Virtually unbeatable in the 65kg category over the past one year in international circuit, Indian wrestler Sujeet Kalkal says "I am my own favourite" even as he remains grounded about the unpredictability of results in elite sport.

Sujeet, who has clinched gold medals in every competition he has entered since that U23 Asian Championship triumph in June 2025 -- barring the Senior World Championship -- believes consistency and self-belief have been key to his rise.

His most recent gold medal-



winning performance came at the Senior Asian Championship in Bishkek.

"I don't follow anyone in

particular. I like watching my own bouts, mostly on Sundays. You can say I am my own favourite," Sujeet said in an interview.

Unlike many of his peers, Sujeet does not idolise any particular wrestler, though he admires veterans like Yogeshwar Dutt, Bajrang Punia and Amit Dhankar for their qualities. "I used to watch Yogeshwar Dutt and others. You learn from them - endurance, speed, power, but I mostly analyse my own bouts. Our schedule is busy, but on Sundays or rest time, I watch my bouts and also those of senior wrestlers.

That helps identify mistakes and improve," he said.

Despite his dominance, Sujeet refused to claim absolute control over the 65kg weight category, which once belonged to Olympics medalist Bajrang Punia, who went out of the scene following protest against then WFI chief Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh.

"There is nothing like no one can shake me. Everyone works hard. Whoever has the day, wins. With God's grace, I have been winning so far and will try to continue doing so and make my country proud," he said.

AGENCIES

SRH'S NEW FACES SHINING

SRH seek home comfort against DC



SRH's Shivang Kumar made the difference against CSK

PTI

HYDERABAD: Sunrisers Hyderabad will look to make home advantage count when they take on inconsistent Delhi Capitals in a mid-table clash of the Indian Premier League here on Tuesday.

Both teams sit on six points, though fourth-placed Sunrisers Hyderabad are marginally ahead, having played a game more and boasting a superior Net Run Rate.

For SRH, the narrative has been one of gradual correction. In the absence of skipper Pat Cummins, who has linked up with the squad but remains unavailable for this game, their bowling unit initially looked thin. But over the last two games, a relatively unheralded group has stepped up. Names like Praful Hinge, Sakib Husain and Shivang Kumar have seized their opportunity, injecting both energy and control into

the attack.

Hinge's standout performance against Rajasthan Royals was followed by a collective bowling effort, led by Eshan Malinga, against Chennai Super Kings, where SRH delivered a clinical exhibition of death bowling, helping them secure back-to-back wins at home. That resurgence with the ball has been central to their recent momentum.

However, the same cannot be said of their batting. SRH's approach remains aggressively high-risk, but the returns have been inconsistent. Openers Travis Head and Abhishek Sharma, along with stand-in captain Ishan Kishan, have not quite clicked together.

The lack of collective starts has repeatedly exposed the middle order. As a result, the burden has largely fallen on Heinrich Klaasen.

AGENCIES

India tagged 'extremely high risk' for doping

MONACO: India was on Monday designated as a country with an "extremely high" risk of doping by World Athletics after topping the list of doping offenders for the past two years, a development which will put the athletes under more stringent anti-doping stipulations.

In a decision taken recently by the Athletics Integrity Unit (AIU) Board, Athletics Federation of India (AFI) has been re-categorised from Category B to Category A under Rule 15 of the World Athletics' Anti-Doping Rules.

"The doping situation in India has been high-risk for a long time and, unfortunately, the quality of the domestic anti-doping programme is simply not proportionate to the doping risk," AIU Chair David Howman said in a release.

"While the AFI has advocated for anti-doping reforms within India, not enough has changed. The AIU will now work with the AFI to achieve reforms to safeguard the integrity of the sport of athletics, as we have done with other 'Category A' Member Federations."

India has ranked in the top two for the most Anti-Doping Rule Violations in athletics between 2022 and 2025.

AGENCIES

Defiant Arteta says Arsenal not pressing panic button



Mikel Arteta said that title charge is on despite losing to City

FILE

However, Arteta felt the nature of his team's performance bodes well for the future.

"I believe today, I believed on Wednesday, I believed a week ago," Arteta said. "Because I see them every day and I know the level that we have. But today, if they need to be more convinced, I think they are now more convinced. They were talking about it in the dressing room. It's a new league now ... everything is still to play for."

Arsenal struck the goal frame twice, through Gabriel Magalhaes and Eberechi Eze,

while Kai Havertz headed over from close range in stoppage time.

"We proved that we are there," Arteta said. "The reality is (in) the two boxes today was a difference. And that's what decided the game."

Arteta doesn't believe he'll need to pick up his players ahead of the final games of the season.

"If I have to pick up the players to win the Premier League, with five games to go, in our hands, and being in the semifinals of the Champions League, I think I should be at home," he said.

AGENCIES

Leisure

'THERE'S NO FUN IN PLAYING VANILLA CHARACTERS'

Jaideep Ahlawat said he always looks to go beyond the tropes of a typical hero

MUMBAI: Actor Jaideep Ahlawat said he always looks to go beyond the tropes of a typical hero and villain role by adding layers to even 'vanilla characters'.

Known for his work in titles like 'Gangs Of Wasseyapur', 'Raees', 'Pataal Lok', 'Broken News', 'Three of Us', 'Jaane Jaan' and 'The Family Man 3', he said he has little interest in playing one-dimensional roles.

"I've not got to play a vanilla character yet. I feel that when the charac-



ter has more layers, it becomes much more interesting to essay that role, as compared to a single-dimensional character. So, if there aren't any layers, I try to put elements or layers in a character to make it look believable as an actor," the actor told PTI in an interview on the sidelines of the book launch event of journalist-turned-author Hussain Zaidi's latest book, 'Mafia Queens of India'.

The 'Pataal Lok' star said his other aim is to make his characters

The 'Pataal Lok' star said his other aim is to make his characters look believable

look believable.

"The emotion with which the character is written must be conveyed so that the story makes sense; otherwise, it becomes flat. As an actor, I feel the more layers in a character, be it a positive or a negative character, the more fun it will be to play such a part," he said.

Ahlawat was most recently seen in a cameo in director Sudip Sharma's 'Kohrra 2'.

PTI



Adarsh Gourav joins 'Alien: EARTH' S2

'Game of Thrones' star Peter Dinklage also joins the star-studded cast of Ridley Scott's series

NEW DELHI: Adarsh Gourav, known for his performance in movies such as 'The White Tiger', 'Kho Gaye Hum Kahan' and 'Tu Yaa Main', is all set to reprise his role in the second season of Ridley Scott's 'Alien: Earth'.

'Game of Thrones' star Peter Dinklage also joins the star-studded cast of the series, which is set to begin filming next month.

Following a widely acclaimed turn in Season 1, Adarsh returns to reprise his role as 'Slightly', a character noted for its emotional depth and complexity. Created by Noah Hawley, with Ridley Scott serving as executive producer, 'Alien: Earth' has quickly established itself as a major global sci-fi title, ranking amongst the top shows of 2025.



The second season will see Adarsh share screen space with a formidable ensemble cast including Sydney Chandler, Alex Lawther, Essie Davis, Sam-

uel Blenkin, Babou Ceesay, Timothy Olyphant and Dinklage.

"Being a part of 'Alien: Earth' has been an incredibly special experience for me. The response to season one, especially to my character, has been truly overwhelming and deeply encouraging. Slightly is such a unique and emotionally complex character and getting the opportunity to explore his journey further in season 2 is something I'm really looking forward to. Working with a team led by visionaries like Noah Hawley and Ridley Scott is inspiring in every sense and being surrounded by such talented co-actors pushes you to constantly grow. I'm excited to get back on set and dive into this world again," Gourav said.

PTI

Sanya Malhotra says she 'learnt to say no over time'



Sanya Malhotra is celebrating a decade in acting this year. Her big break came in 2016 with Aamir Khan's 'Dangal', portraying wrestler Babita Kumari. Despite limited screen time, she built a strong reputation through standout roles in acclaimed mid-budget films and major commercial hits.

Hailing from Delhi as an outsider, Sanya Malhotra carved her path in showbiz independently. Yet, mastering the art of turning down uncomfortable patterns proved her biggest challenge.

"I learnt how to say no over time. Now, I say it quite easily. But it took me some time. I used to have panic attacks before I said no. I used to wonder, 'How do I say no?' I'd be worried that if I do

that, I may not get work after that. And even if I somehow did it, I'd carry this guilt for months on end. Apart from me not getting more opportunities, I was afraid that he might have been offended," she tells 'News18'.

The actress now follows a mantra of being polite yet firm. "You need to understand that a film is a director's medium. But you, as an actor, can definitely give your suggestions. Sometimes, they listen to you and sometimes, they don't. But I learnt it the hard way that if I don't say no, it'd mean that I'm only living their dream and doing things their way instead of living my own life," she remarked.

The actress elaborated, "I believe that there's a way to put your point across."

AGENCIES